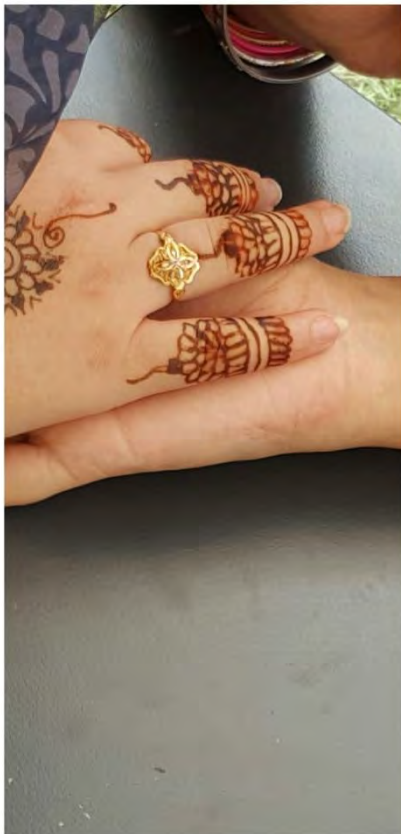




**NORTHERN SETTLEMENT
SERVICES LIMITED**



**Annual Report
2016 / 17**

Contents

Chairperson's Report	8
Chief Executive Officer's Report	10
Organisational Highlights	12
Settlement Services Program Reports	14
<i>Settlement Services Team Manager</i>	17
<i>Hunter Outreach Settlement Services Program</i>	21
<i>New England Settlement Services Program Armidale</i>	25
<i>New England Settlement Services Program Tamworth</i>	28
<i>Settlement Services Program - Newcastle</i>	31
<i>Settlement Services Program Volunteer Program – Welfare</i>	34
<i>Settlement Services Program and Pathways to Volunteering</i>	36
<i>Settlement Services Program - Newcastle</i>	39
<i>Settlement Services Program - Arabic Speaking Settlement Worker</i>	41
<i>Settlement Services Program Multicultural Youth Project</i>	43
<i>Settlement Services Program Volunteer Coordination</i>	48
<i>Settlement Services Program - Central Coast</i>	51
<i>Settlement & Community Team - Playing Around the World (PAW) Central Coast</i>	54
<i>Settlement & Community Team – Multicultural Community Development</i>	57
Aged Services Reports	59
<i>Aged Services Manager</i>	61
<i>Home Care Packages (HCP)</i>	63
<i>Sector Support & Development – Multicultural Access Project Hunter (MAP)</i>	66
<i>Hunter Multicultural Respite Service</i>	71
<i>Newcastle Multicultural Support Service Group</i>	73
<i>Multicultural Social Support Service Central Coast</i>	75
<i>Chinese Social Support Project</i>	78

<i>Community Visitors Scheme (CVS) - Hunter</i>	<i>80</i>
<i>Community Visitors Scheme (CVS) – Central Coast</i>	<i>82</i>
Multicultural Family Support & Welfare Reports.....	84
<i>Multicultural Family Support & Welfare</i>	<i>86</i>
<i>Early Intervention & Placement Prevention (EIPP) Program.....</i>	<i>86</i>
<i>Multicultural Family Support Project – Families First</i>	<i>88</i>
<i>Brighter Futures Program.....</i>	<i>91</i>
<i>Early Intervention Program</i>	<i>91</i>
<i>Complex Case Support Program</i>	<i>93</i>
Snapshots.....	96
Events that NSS has participated in 2016-17.....	96
Immigration Advice & Assistance	104
<i>Immigration Advice & Assistance</i>	<i>105</i>
Financial Statements.....	106

Our Mission Statement

*To facilitate the successful integration of individuals
& communities of non-English speaking
background, into Australian life,
in an environment sensitive &
responsive to their needs.*

Office Locations

LOCATION	POSTAL ADDRESS	PHONE	FAX	EMAIL
HAMILTON (Head Office) 8 Chaucer Street Hamilton NSW 2303	As location	4969 3399	4961 4997	nss@nsservices.com.au
CENTRAL COAST Tuggerah Lakes Community Centre 1 Bay Village Road Bateau Bay NSW 2261	PO Box 4167 Bay Village NSW 2261	4334 3877	4334 3044	cc@nsservices.com.au
ARMIDALE Hughes House 141 Faulkner Street Armidale NSW 2350	Same as street address	6771 3975	6771 3691	nssarm@nsservices.com.au
TAMWORTH Suite 10 56-58 Dowe Street Tamworth NSW 2340	As location	6766 5070	Not avail.	nsstam@nsservices.com.au

Service Regions

- **Hunter** – Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Port Stephens, Maitland, Cessnock, Singleton, Muswellbrook, Dungog, Scone, Merriwa & Murrurundi
- **Central Coast** – Gosford & Wyong
- **Northern Tablelands** – Tamworth & Armidale
- **Other Regions Supported** – North West & Central West NSW

Board of Management - 30 June 2017

Ms Trudy Mills-Evers AM	Chair
Mr Jon Chin	Deputy Chair
Ms Christine Jordan	Treasurer, Public Officer
Ms Ewa Korczynski	Secretary
Ms Anna Marendy	Director
Mr Zoran Vasiljevic	Director
Ms Sania Young	Director
Father Nicholas Zervas OAM	Director
Mr Zachary Ekandi	Director
Cr. Barney Langford	Co-opted Member, Lake Macquarie City Council

NSS Audit Committee - 30 June 2017

- **Ms Christine Jordan – Chair**
- **Ms Trudy Mills-Evers AM**
- **Ms Ewa Korczynski**
- **Mr Bruce Arnott – Independent Member**

NSS Staff - 30 June 2017

Chief Executive Officer	Lulu Tantos
Operations Manager	Enza Di Stefano
Operations Support Officer	Katie Sewell
Migration Agents	Lulu Tantos & Henriette de Jong
Finance Manager	Kerry Blades
Finance Officer	Kathy Rowarth
Administration	John Pattey, Natasha Holliday & Violeta Klements
Work Health & Safety Officer	Helen Buchanan
Office Manager - Central Coast	Keiko Clements
Administration - Central Coast	Sharlene Huber
Settlement Services Team Manager	Alex Burns & Debbie Carstens (Locum)
Hunter Outreach SSP Worker	Rose Oku
New England SSP Worker - Tamworth	Amalin Sundaravej
New England SSP Worker - Armidale	Judith Roberts
Central Coast SSP Worker	Nellie Srisurapon
Newcastle / Lake Macquarie Settlement Workers	Lydia Manusiu & Hayley Bateman
CALD Youth Worker - SSP	Tonkoh Kamara
Settlement Worker (Arabic)	Lena Alameddine
Congolese SSP Worker	Marie Zawadi
Volunteers Coordinator (Educational Programs)	Michael Freund
Volunteers Coordinator (Welfare Programs)	Cassie Galliot Abby Tinlin & Lena Alameddine
Multicultural Community Development Workers - Central Coast	Pari Batha & Natalia Meliendrez
Aged Services Team Manager	Rasa Bajalis
Sector Support & Development Coordinator - Hunter	John Biswas
Home Care Packages Coordinators	Tima 'Oto, Lupe Fonua
Hunter Multicultural Respite Service Coordinator	Tima 'Oto
Community Visitors Scheme Coordinator - Hunter	Irene Lupish
Hunter Multicultural Social Support Project Worker	Tima 'Oto
Chinese Social Support Project Worker	Dongmei Zhang
Multicultural Social Support Service Coordinator - Central Coast	Marilín Pérez Cabrera & Natalia Meliendrez
Community Visitors Scheme Coordinator - Central Coast	Nicky Wright
Welfare Team Manager	Petrona Kelly
Multicultural Family Worker	Miza Torlakovic
Multicultural Welfare Workers	Juanita Loli, Elena Ferguson, Hayley Bateman & Lydia Manusiu
Brighter Futures Worker	Zenaida Edmunds
Tax Help & EAPA	
Coordinator	Juanita Loli

Funding Partnerships

Department of Social Services through the NSW Settlement Partnership	NSW Department of Education
Department of Health	Multicultural NSW, Unity Grant
NSW Department of Family & Community Services	The Benevolent Society
NSW Department of Family & Community Services, Ageing Disability & HomeCare	Samaritans Foundation
NSW Department of Family and Community Services, Community Services - Families NSW	ClubsNSW
Commonwealth Home Support Program	Central Coast Council

Our Supporters

We wish to acknowledge and thank all our stakeholders for their continued support of the many and diverse programs delivered throughout the past year.

Networking & Interagencies

Northern Settlement Services supports a range of networks including the Mid North Coast, North Coast & Hunter Rural Multicultural Networks; the Central West, Central Coast, Newcastle & New England Multicultural Interagencies; the Hunter Refugee Network, the Hunter Culturally and Linguistically Diverse (CALD) Aged & Disability Services Network, Settlement Council of Australia (SCoA) and Humanitarian Social Support (HSS) Local Area Committee (LAC).



Acronyms:

Northern Settlement Services Ltd - NSS

Culturally and Linguistically Diverse - CALD



Chairperson's Report

Trudy Mills - Evers AM

NSS has had another successful year with many achievements to be proud of. As I reflect on our organisational highlights for the last year I can confidently say our programs have had a major impact on the lives of our client population across the Hunter, Central Coast and New England regions of NSW.

The past year has also seen growth and great results in partnerships with Settlement Services International (SSI) and the Department of Health growing our capacity to deliver services to newly arrived Syrian and Iraqi refugees and to our ever increasing aged care population.

None of this would be possible without our dedicated staff who contribute so much and in particular our CEO Lulu Tantos, who manages and represents the organisation on a daily basis and contributes on a State and National Level on issues and policy affecting our client group.

I would also like to take this opportunity to thank our outgoing Operations Manager Enza Di Stefano, who has been an integral part of the NSS team. To our great loss Enza decided to retire at the end of the financial year. We will certainly miss her

expertise and operational skills. Enza is replaced by Katie Sewell who brings her own wealth of knowledge and strengths to the team.

The community sector in which we operate has experienced a range of State and Federal reforms over recent years. To stay relevant and competitive in this environment, NSS like many organisations has seized this opportunity to review our purpose and strategies, explore partnerships and funding opportunities and evolve and improve quality of governance.

Recognising the need to continually improve and to help steer NSS into the future the Board is working closely with management and staff to undertake a strategic planning review of the organisation. Our aim is to ensure that NSS continues to move forward successfully with a focus on client centred service delivery, innovation and quality programs and partnerships and collaborations.

I would like to acknowledge and thank our numerous volunteers for their unselfish and magnificent contribution they make in the lives of our clients.

This extends of course to my fellow Board members who give freely of their time to contribute to the governance and success of this organisation.

On behalf of NSS I would also like to thank all our partners and

funding bodies who continue to recognise and support the valuable work we do.

I wish everyone a peaceful, healthy and successful year ahead.



NSS CEO Lulu Tantos with the Hon John Ajaka MLC and NSS Chairperson Trudy Mills- Evers AM at the Community Advisors Graduation Ceremony.



Chief Executive Officer's Report

Lulu Tantos

It is my pleasure to present this Annual Report on behalf of the organisation and our remarkable staff whose achievements over 2016 – 2017 are highlighted in this report.

At NSS we believe a diverse workforce is essential to strengthen our capacity. We achieve outcomes by drawing on the different strengths, attributes and characteristics of the many individuals who make up our teams.

We are committed to a culture that is fair and inclusive. A robust and agile organisation relies on every person having the opportunity to contribute to their full potential.

So while 2016-2017 has been a time of change and growth, one thing that remained consistent is the extraordinary work of our staff and volunteers whose diligence and commitment is surpassed only by their passion for the work they do.

By working together and in partnerships with our stakeholders, NSS is dedicated to making sure our clients are empowered to have their voices heard and to participate in the social and economic life of their communities. As is evident throughout this report, NSS delivers a range of wrap around services that help sustain our clients in their daily lives as well as offering engagement initiatives that help foster a sense of social inclusion.

We understand that the best outcomes are achieved through an integrated service which understands

and respects the people place and potential of communities.

During 2016 – 2017 NSS has expanded into areas that are in keeping with our values and that complement our existing services and integrate well with them.

This is no more evident than in our Aged Services area where NSS was successful in securing Growth Funding under the Commonwealth Home Support Programme for the delivery of In-Home Day Respite for people from CALD backgrounds in the Hunter and Central Coast.

This year has also seen NSS employ for the first time its own care support staff directly. Commencing in the Hunter Multicultural Respite Program, supporting our Centre Based Day Care clients at the Greek, Polish and Italian Wellness Centres, with a view to employing additional care support staff across our aged care programs.

This year also has had some very interesting highlights and developments including:

- The Humanitarian Settlement Program (HSP) tender lodged in April 2017 in partnership with Settlement Services International and its 11 member partners collectively bidding for 3 NSW contract regions – Canberra & surrounds, Sydney and Regional NSW. This bid represents a huge opportunity for the organisation to regain and deliver services to humanitarian entrants on arrival in Australia through a tailored

- needs based case management approach.
- Additional funds from SSI through the Department of Social Services to provide new settlement growth activity, providing support for additional clients resulting from the increased intake of refugees from Syria and Iraq. The additional allocation of funds allowed us to employ an Arabic speaking case worker, to deal more effectively with those families and individuals.
 - The implementation of the CALD Disability Engagement project in partnership with the Multicultural Disability Advocacy Association, Ethnic Community Services Cooperative, Ageing Disability & Home Care (ADHC) and the National Disability Insurance Agency. Implemented through a community Advisor Strategy the project supported people from CALD communities identify and access suitable supports through the NDIS, including accessing community mainstream supports. At the conclusion of the project 43 community advisors representing the Arabic, Chinese, Congolese, Filipino and South Sudanese communities attended a graduation ceremony officiated by the Hon John Ajaka MLC who presented certificates to the graduates.
 - Hosting of the Settlement Council of Australia (SCoA) Employment Innovation Forum to share existing good practice examples of employment initiatives being implemented in the region which included our Multicultural Small Business Program and engage

participants in working together to identify gaps and opportunities for building on existing work.

- Taking part in the Hunter CALD Elder Abuse Prevention Campaign, launched by the Hon Tanya Davies MP on 8 May 2017 in collaboration with NSW Elder Abuse Helpline and Resource Unit, NSW Seniors Rights Services, ECC of NSW, Wesley Mission, Multicultural Health Services, NSW Police, MDAA, ECC of Newcastle & the Primary Health Network Hunter & Central Coast.
- The ongoing Targeted Early Intervention (TEI) program Reform by FACS of its service system affecting 3 of our funded programs; Child Youth And Family Support (CYFS), Community Builders and Families NSW, with the intention of improving outcomes for clients of TEI services through a service system continuum rounded in evidence based best practice by targeting resources to those with the greatest needs.

As the Service delivery capacity of NSS continues to grow, I look forward to our organisation continuing to play a central role not just in supporting those in immediate need, but also in working with our colleagues and partners in the sector and with governments of all levels, to help create policies and services that ensure the best possible outcomes for our clients.

With many new opportunities on the horizon, the year ahead looks promising, I thank the NSS Board of Directors and my Senior Management Team for their support and efforts over what has been a hectic but rewarding year.

Organisational Highlights

10,170



CLIENTS
PROVIDED WITH CASE
MANAGEMENT
SESSIONS

APPROXIMATELY

1,398



CLIENTS WERE
SUPPORTED BY
VOLUNTEERS
PER SESSION



111

CLIENTS ATTENDED
ENGLISH
CONVERSATION
CLASSES WHILE

19

CHILDREN
ACCESSED CRECHE

APPROXIMATELY

3,292

PEOPLE PARTICIPATED
IN GROUP
SESSIONS



APPROXIMATELY

50,526

PEOPLE ATTENDED
THE 61 EVENTS
WE WERE A PART OF

262 \$

PEOPLE WERE
ASSISTED
THROUGH THE
ENERGY ACCOUNTS
PAYMENT
ASSISTANCE SCHEME
(EAPA)

of Congo, Eritrea, Ethiopia, Fiji, FYROM, Germany, Greece, Holland, India, Indonesia, Iran, Iraq, Israel, Italy, Japan, Jordan, Kenya, Korea, Latvia,

APPROXIMATELY



226

**VOLUNTEERS
PROVIDED SUPPORT**

108 \$

**PEOPLE ACCESSED
TAX HELP**

APPROXIMATELY



2,000

PEOPLE REFERRED



**CLIENTS CAME FROM
MORE THAN**

70 **DIFFERENT
COUNTRIES**

2,900

**INSTANCES OF WELFARE
SUPPORT PROVIDED
TO CLIENTS**

936

**SETTLEMENT SERVICE
CLIENT SUPPORTED**

380

**AGED SERVICE CLIENTS
SUPPORTED**

700

**IMMIGRATION SERVICE
SESSIONS**



62

**VOLUNTEERS
ATTENDED NSS
GATHERINGS**

Settlement Services Program Reports



**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

Settlement Team



Alex Burns
Settlement Team Manager



Debbie Carstens
*Settlement Team Manager
(Locum)*



Rose Oku
*Settlement Worker Hunter
Outreach*



Marie Zawadi
Settlement Worker Newcastle



Tonkoh Kamara
Youth Worker



Michael Freund
Volunteers Coordinator Education



Abby Tinlin
*Settlement Worker
Pathways to Volunteering
Coordinator
Volunteers Coordinator Welfare*



Lena Alameddine
*Settlement Worker (Arabic)
Volunteer Coordinator Welfare*



Lydia Manusiu
*Senior
Settlement Worker Newcastle*



Nellie Srisurapon
*Settlement Worker
Central Coast*



Natalia Meliendrez
*Multicultural Community
Development Central Coast*



Pari Batha *Multicultural
Community Development
Central Coast*

Settlement Team



Judith Roberts
Settlement Worker
Armidale



Amalin Sundaravej
Settlement Worker
Tamworth



Cassie Galliot
Settlement Worker
Newcastle



Hayley Bateman
Settlement Worker
Newcastle

Settlement Services Team Manager

**Alex Burns &
Debbie Carstens
(Locum Settlement Services Manager)**

**Funded by
Department of Social Services through the
NSW Settlement Partnership,
NSW Department of Family and Community
Services and The Benevolent Society**

Project Target Group(s)

Newly arrived people from migrant, refugee and humanitarian backgrounds in the first 5 years of their settlement in Australia; and CALD families and communities on the Central Coast.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle, Central Coast, Hunter and New England.

Project Brief

Support, supervise and promote the development of the work of the Settlement Team and Central Coast Community Team. Engage with government policy and wider networks to monitor the policy and practice environment, and to advocate on behalf of our client groups in regional areas. Facilitate and support multicultural Interagencies across our regions.

Highlights and Achievements

Syrian and Iraqi families

Newcastle's refugee intake this year reflected the national focus on the Syrian and Iraqi conflicts, and support for refugees from those countries. As the Syrian and Iraqi people arrived in our community supported by Navitas English under the Humanitarian Settlement Services (HSS) program, we started to see the children registering in our Homework and Learning Centres and the young people engaging in various youth programs. Our Taree Cultural Exchange program in July 2016 included several recently arrived Syrian and Iraqi youth.

In February 2017 we were able to employ an Arabic speaking Settlement Worker, with additional funding from the Department of Social Services, recognising the need for additional settlement services once the Syrian and Iraqi cohort were exited from the intensive HSS program. From commencement Lena Alameddine has been very busy supporting the Syrian and Iraqi families in addressing a range of issues, and supporting them

in understanding various aspects of Australian society. June 2016, we had received 26 Arabic speaking families. The group who have come to Newcastle from this cohort have had very limited English language skills, making the work with this group demanding.

In August 2016 Service for the Treatment And Rehabilitation of Torture and Trauma Survivors (STARTTS) asked NSS to partner with them and others in establishing a Multicultural Youth Group. This regular Wednesday afternoon social, recreational and sporting program has become a great gathering place for young people of many different cultural backgrounds, and a venue for regular engagement with and support of young people. The young people have had significant input into how the group has run. This group has embraced the Syrian and Iraqi young people and has provided a safe place for them.

Employment

Employment continues as a significant issue for the multicultural communities of Newcastle. Our Hunter Multicultural Employment Reference Group, commenced in April 2016, has now become an established network of multicultural service providers and mainstream employment service providers, with improved collaboration and service delivery as a result. We have developed a resource list of multicultural service providers as a guide for employment service providers to know where to go to for support in addressing the needs of their multicultural clients. Conversely, employment service providers have

provided key contact details for their organisations so we have people we can go to in order to resolve individual issues for clients. The Department of Employment has been an active player in the Reference Group and has invited NSS to attend the meetings they convene with all the employment service providers so we can receive updates on programs alongside them.

Extra energy was given to this collaboration through a Settlement Council of Australia (SCOA) Employment Innovation Forum run in Newcastle on 16th March 2017. The Forum gave a wider perspective to the issues we had been discussing, assisted us to engage a wider network of employment service providers, and gave us more time to brainstorm important issues and creative responses.

A project that has come from the Employment Reference Group has been a pilot Multicultural Small Business Program. This was run as collaboration between Newcastle City Council, The Business Centre, Northern Settlement Services, Navitas English and the Catholic Refugee Service. Two groups of ten people from refugee backgrounds undertook the program. Sessions were delivered with an Arabic interpreter to one group, which consisted of newly arrived Syrian and Iraqi people. Sessions for the other group were delivered in English and participants were largely from African background. There were 5 workshops delivered to each group and then personalised business advisory sessions were provided individually or with

small groups of people planning to go into business together.

At the end of the program a graduation was held and all those interested in pursuing catering businesses were invited to cater for the event. It was a wonderful celebration and a great taste success. Newcastle City Council commissioned a video about the program and it can be viewed at <https://vimeo.com/219333798> There was a wealth of learning from the pilot that is informing future plans for our programs and work around development of small businesses.

Events

Running of and participation in multicultural events continues to be a significant element of our work, celebrating multiculturalism, building capacity of emerging communities to participate and contribute, and linking multicultural communities to mainstream service providers and community. This year our Settlement Team and Central Coast Community Team were involved in more than 20 events across our 4 regions.

Armidale Carnivale in April 2017 was a first time event and centred on multicultural dances in the street and town hall. 500 people attended during the afternoon and evening, and many didn't want to go home at the end. It was so successful the community has asked to make it an annual event. Maitland Riverlights multicultural festival was in its 4th year and drew an estimated crowd of some 10,000 people. The Central Coast Multicultural Expo was in its 11th year, and continues to grow.

Refugee Week in Newcastle was significant this year. We held a very successful community celebration at Hunter Multicultural Communities in Waratah, with a wide range of activities including a drumming workshop, circus skills, a jumping castle, fitness testing, soccer, volleyball and much more. The evening concluded with an Iftar dinner, breaking the fast with our Muslim community members from refugee backgrounds, followed by dancing. Participation from a wide range of former refugee communities from Africa, the Middle East and other regions was great.

Also during Refugee Week we held two screenings of *Constance on the Edge*, a movie tracing a Sudanese family over 10 years of highs and lows on their journey to settle in Wagga Wagga. Some 90 people attended the day time session and 110 attended the evening session. The events were facilitated by Tonkoh Kamara and Esther Kalenga, both former refugees themselves. There was good input from the panel discussions at the end of each screening, especially the former refugee panellists, and good discussion with the audience. We used the day time screening as an opportunity for TAFE to highlight the achievements of the Adult Migrant Education Program (AMEP) program over many years as this contract now moves to another provider.

All three Newcastle Refugee Week events owe their success to the wide partnership of organisations contributing in a variety of ways.

Staff

Towards the end of the year our long standing, skilled and well respected Armidale Settlement Worker, Judith Roberts, indicated her intention to resign. We were very fortunate when she offered to stay in the role until we had recruited a new worker so she could train them and do an extensive handover. Sincere thanks to Judith for all her hard work over more than 10 years, especially acknowledging the additional challenges she faced being a lone Settlement Worker in a regional community.

We also said goodbye to Cassie Galliot and Hayley Bateman from our

Settlement Team, who both moved interstate. Many thanks to them for their contribution to the team in volunteer co-ordination, casework, group work and a range of other activities.

It has been a privilege to work alongside and support such a talented and committed staff team, who are widely respected in their local communities and by their colleagues in the multicultural sector and beyond.

Hunter Outreach Settlement Services Program

Rose Oku

**Funded by
Department of Social Services through the
NSW Settlement Program**

Project Target Group(s)

Eligible newly arrived people from migrant, refugee and humanitarian backgrounds in the first 5 years of their settlement in Australia. In rural and regional areas of the Upper Hunter this includes temporary residents on spouse visas and the dependents of temporary skilled visa holders.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

The Hunter Settlement Services outreach work covers Upper Hunter, Port Stephens, and Lake Macquarie areas.

Project Brief

Provides settlement services to assist newly arrived, disadvantaged refugees and migrants, especially women who are experiencing hardship through isolation, unemployment, domestic violence, and homelessness. Casework, group work and community development activities are undertaken. The aim is to empower clients to participate equitably in Australian society as soon as possible after arrival.

Highlights and Achievements

The overall highlight for 2016 to 2017 was increasing multicultural community participation in activities in all the service areas, and an increase in networking with other agencies

leading to improved planning and outcomes. This year the client group has again been from diverse cultural backgrounds including China, Philippines, Japan, Indonesia, African Nations, Fiji India, Bangladesh, Nepal, Peru, Thailand, Sri Lanka, Korea and Pakistan.

Belonging in the Hunter Valley – Consultation and Report

The Hunter Rural Multicultural Network held a community consultation



'Belonging in the Hunter Valley. This successful event addressed both the positive and negative aspects of living in the Upper Hunter. It brought together local service providers, members from the multicultural community and TAFE students from the Singleton, Muswellbrook and Upper Hunter areas who were invited to share personal experiences, issues and hopes.

Participants were from an array of multicultural backgrounds including; Philippines, Africa, Bangladesh, China, Russia, Taiwan, Indonesia, England and India just to name a few.

The main activity of the day was the discussion based on 4 set questions -

What is good about living in the Hunter Valley? What is challenging about living in the Hunter Valley? What would make the community better? Where do you go when you need help?

These discussions were held in small groups and then reported back, followed by a plenary session on potential responses to the challenges identified.

Participants developed a greater awareness of the community's multicultural services and that there are many positives to living in the Hunter. Key issues identified were social isolation and unemployment.

A report of the consultation has been compiled and the Hunter Rural Multicultural Network are working on an Action Plan building on the outcomes.

Casework

Hunter Settlement Services Outreach supports clients to address client needs, by empowering them to reach their potential through Casework. This allows for the creation of clear referral pathways to access resources, and appropriate services within their own community. Referrals were made to a wide range of services for example ;

tenancy and accommodation, Centrelink, Medicare, Translating Interpreters Service (TIS), Education and Training, counselling, childcare facilities, family referrals, Employment, women's refuges, playgroups, welfare and charity organisations, National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS), NSW Service for the Treatment And Rehabilitation of Torture and Trauma Survivors (STARTTS), Ability Links, Refugee Health, NSW Legal Aid, Police Citizens Youth Club (PCYC), Multicultural Disability and NSW Police.

The Hunter Settlement Services outreach provided;

- 876 client contacts including; face to face, telephone and email support.
- These clients were dealing with a wide range of issues and accessing services for; unemployment, financial issues, utilities payments, social isolation, accommodation, women's health, mental health, Medicare, counselling, migration issues, Legal Aid, interpreters, language classes, isolation, transport, cultural and family relationships.



Group Work:

During 2016-17 there were;

- 22 group sessions across the project regions.
- 12 group sessions were held in Singleton with 22 people attending each session;
- 7 sessions were held in Cessnock with 17 people attending each session and;
- 3 sessions were held in Raymond Terrace with 25 people attending each session.

These sessions were provided in partnership with external providers including; Community Health, Hunter Prelude, New England Local Health District, Thou-Walla Family Centre, Samaritans, Tenancy Advice Service, Singleton Council, Maitland Council, Centrelink, Job Network, Micro-finance, NDIS Ability Links.

Topics Covered included; Employment, Women's Health, Social Isolation,

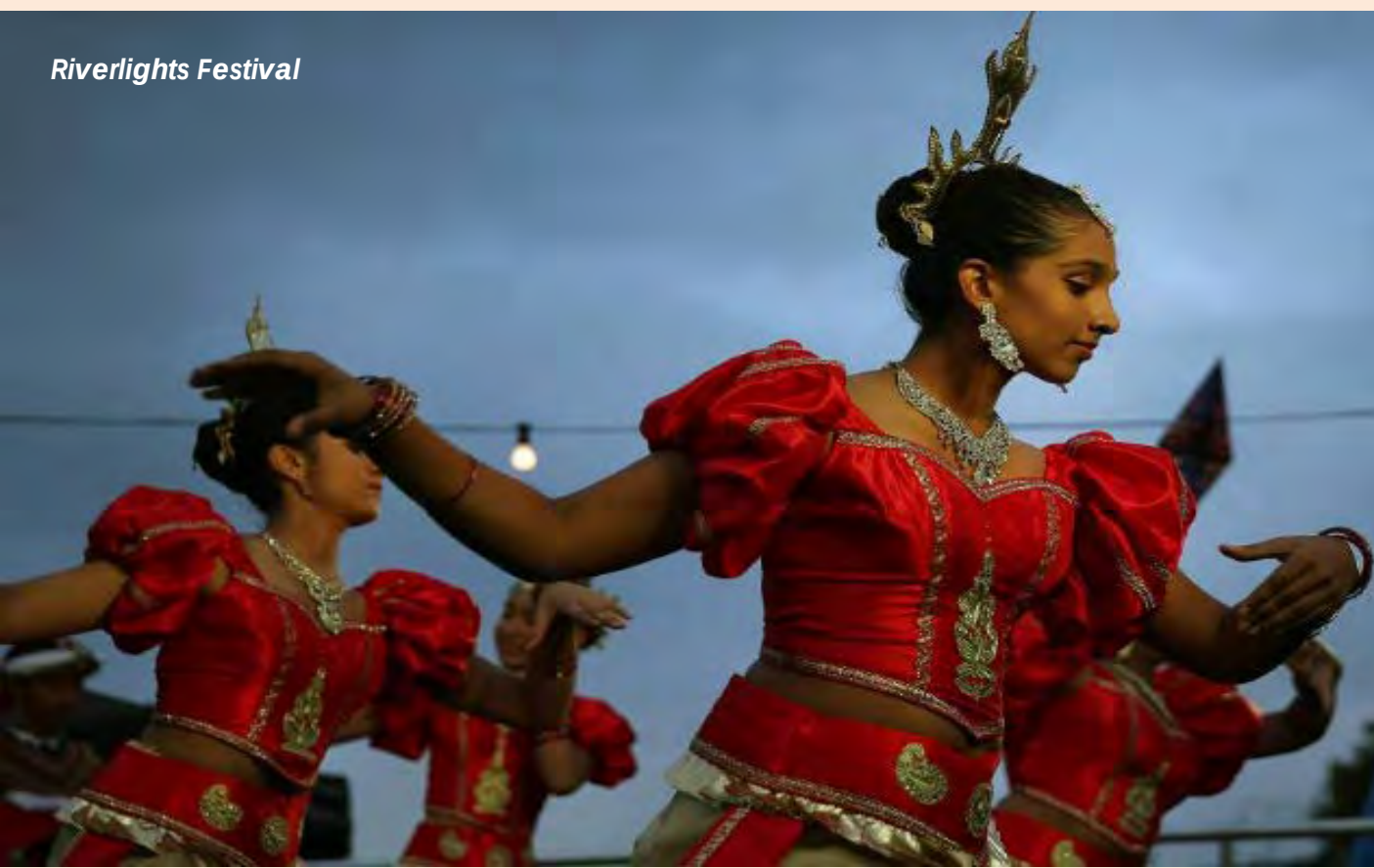
Capacity Building, Education, Family Relationships, Community Participation at Local Events, Centrelink Payments, Practical Business Support and Disaster Resilience and Preparedness.

Group Participation in Community Activities and Events

Hunter Settlement Services Outreach was involved in 38 community events and activities during 2016-17. The target group members participated in community activities including Harmony Day with some volunteering to speak at schools, clubs etc. The Hunter Settlement Services worker continued as convener of 3 quarterly meetings of the Hunter Rural Multicultural Network (HRMN).

Outcomes of group work and community participation: Clients are establishing community networks by volunteering and participating in community events and organisations. The target group are developing and maintaining a firm support network within the groups and are developing

Riverlights Festival



ongoing friends outside the group activities to help each other in everyday life.

Promotional Activities

Throughout 2016-17 the Hunter Settlement Worker attended over 10 Promotional activities and networking events and promotional activities, many involving participation in interagency and presentations to specific organisations and schools.

The 6th Annual Riverlights Festival in Maitland was held on 10th October 2016 was attended by approximately 10,000 people. On Saturday 8th

November 2016, the Raymond Terrace Multicultural Fiesta was held at the Riverside Park to celebrate Multicultural Diversity. Both festivals provided culturally diverse experiences for the community which included music, dance, food demonstrations and language learning. NSS staff helped in the organisation and planning of both events and provided an information table at both festivals with Face Painting activities for kids at each festival.

Riverlights Festival



New England Settlement Services Program Armidale

Judith Roberts

**Funded by
Department of Social Services through the
NSW Settlement Program**

Project Target Group(s)

Eligible newly arrived people from migrant, refugee and humanitarian backgrounds in the first 5 years of their settlement in Australia. As a rural and regional area this includes temporary residents on spouse visas and the dependents of temporary skilled visa holders.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Armidale and surrounds.

Project Brief

The Settlement Service Program (SSP) aims to increase independence, knowledge, and ability for humanitarian entrants and eligible new arrivals, to navigate and access mainstream services and promote self-reliance. Eligible clients are supported in their settlement by casework and coordination, information and referrals, advocacy, information sessions, promotion, settlement support groups, community development, networking and mentoring.

Case Work and Referrals

Clients come from a range of cultural backgrounds including Syria, Iraq, Saudi Arabia, Nigeria, Sudan (South),

Ethiopia, Bangladesh, Mongolia and The Philippines.

Clients have received assistance in identifying and applying for housing, referral to migration assistance through NSS, negotiation with and access to crisis support services, information and capacity building seminars and activities, and generalist ongoing support such as form filling and financial management referrals to organisations such as Sanctuary Armidale and St Vincent de Paul. Access to employment opportunities figured prominently among the issues and challenges faced by Armidale CALD community members as did alcohol abuse and lack of access to affordable driving instruction and licensing for women.

Armidale Multicultural Women's Group

The groups were held at Armidale Uniting Church Hall in partnership with Hunter New England Health (HNEH) Multicultural Health. The Multicultural Women's Group meets Tuesday morning each week and provides a platform for CALD women to meet, talk and support each other in a friendly and culturally sensitive environment. The group was facilitated by NSS Settlement Worker and Joy Harrison and Robbie Murphy

of Hunter New England Health and hosts discussion, seminars and information on women's health and well-being related topics. 15 women regularly attend and is set to grow with the announced resettlement of refugee's in Armidale in early 2018.

The Music, Movement and Storytelling Program (4 weeks). October 2016

Run at Hughes House, Armidale the music, movement and storytelling program assisted women and children in building their confidence, social networks and independence and further built social cohesion of families from differing cultural backgrounds with the Armidale community. The program was facilitated by an experienced early childhood teacher/musician (Steph Watts) and was put together through planning and collaboration between NSW Service for the Treatment And Rehabilitation of Torture and Trauma Survivors (STARTTS), NSS, Armidale Homelessness Support, HNEH and local Migrant and Refugee Women. The program highlighted the need for the establishment of further activities and programs to support CALD families into the future.

Armidale Multicultural Homework Centre

Held at Drummond Memorial Public School each Tuesday and Wednesday, the Homework Centre provides valuable support for CALD students from both primary and secondary schools in the area. Facilitated by Fay Paris and a team of dedicated volunteers, the homework centre assists students in

understanding and completing homework tasks, interacting with each other and building upon their confidence, social skilling and existing language and literacy skills. The homework centre regularly hosts around 10-15 students each session and is growing steadily.

The Carnivale Armidale - Multicultural Celebration and Dance

The Carnivale Armidale - Multicultural Celebration and Dance held in April 2017 was a great success. More than 600 people from a diverse range of community backgrounds attended the event, participated in dancing and enjoyed the celebration. As a result of the events success and community support the participants and the planning committee are keen to now make this an annual event.

The event focused on communities being invited to perform a dance from their cultural background, followed by them inviting the audience to get up and learn the dance as well. Performances were in two places – inside the Town Hall and on the street outside the Town Hall.

Food stalls were set up outside for people to enjoy food from different cultures, and information stalls were also available showcasing some of the local service providers and a couple of businesses.

Some highlights in the evaluation comments were –

- It was a wonderful inclusive, joyous celebration event
- The indigenous dancers starting off the event and then

had fun joining in the
Vietnamese dancing

- Participatory dancing is what made the event so good – so many people joined in
- Children and adults loved the bush dancing
- Family friendly, alcohol free outdoor event was great



NSS Staff member Judith Robert and Jacaranda Social Club facilitator Stephanie Watts join the participants of the The Music, Movement and Storytelling program for a group photo

New England Settlement Services Program Tamworth

Amalin Sundaravej

**Funded by
Department of Social Services through the
NSW Settlement Program**

Project Target Group(s)

Eligible newly arrived people from migrant, refugee and humanitarian backgrounds in the first 5 years of their settlement in Australia. As a rural and regional area this includes temporary residents on spouse visas and the dependents of temporary skilled visa holders.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Tamworth and surrounding communities in the New England.

Project Brief

The Settlement Service Program (SSP) aims to increase independence, knowledge, and ability for humanitarian and refugee entrants and eligible new arrivals, to navigate and access mainstream services and promote self-reliance in Tamworth and surrounding communities. Eligible clients are supported in their settlement by casework and coordination, information and referrals, advocacy, information sessions, promotion, settlement support groups, community development, networking and mentoring.

Client Services

NSS Tamworth has assisted and supported thirty six new clients coming

from; Argentina, Colombia, India, Iran, Malaysia, Myanmar, Nigeria, Philippines (13), Sri Lanka, Singapore, Serbia, Thailand, Venezuela, Vietnam and USA.

The newly arrived Karen refugees from Myanmar have been one focus of client casework as Tamworth is their first settlement. Learning the English language, through their attendance at Adult Migrant Education Program (AMEP), was made a top priority recognising that English literacy is an essential skill for coping with the many demands of life in contemporary Australia. They are learning to drive and are connecting to the community through various activities.

Three cases of domestic violence have been supported in collaboration with the Tamworth Family Support Services. Networking and building relationships has played a big role in providing safety for the women victims of violence.

Employment

Approximately 65% of client casework involved referrals to employment or job agencies, formally and informally. In Tamworth, extensive low skilled employment opportunities for new migrants and refugees continue with employment in the abattoirs (lamb and beef) and chicken agricultural

processing plants, which are three of the major sources of employment.

Most referrals were to local employment agencies but importantly, NSS has built up a good rapport with on-site job recruiter, Regional Work Force Management, who screens clients as to their suitability for a job at the beef factory. Functional English literacy is the minimum for work place health and safety requirements.

Major Events

Fiesta La Peel Multicultural Street Festival

Fiesta La Peel (FLP) Multicultural Street Festival in its third year running, was a major highlight for the community. This event is growing in popularity each year. Fiesta La Peel saw dozens of stallholders line either side of Peel Street to showcase the food, art, dance, language and traditional dress of the birth country of so many local community members, as thousands of residents lapped up the myriad of cultures that define Tamworth. In an explosion of colour, the street came alive with lion dancers, belly dancers, interactive drumming, art and craft workshops and food from almost every pocket of the world. The breakdown of stall holders, showing the number of participants we had for Fiesta La Peel in each category was: Non-commercial food vendors (11), Commercial food vendors (12),

Service providers (16), Entertainers (15), Art /Craft (7), Commercial Retail (9). NSS continues to be an active member of the FLP organising committee, especially ensuring the engagement of the various local migrant and refugee communities.

Clean Up Australia Day (March 2017)

Seventy two people from migrant and refugee backgrounds, led by the Filipinos Association of Tamworth (FIAT), picked up rubbish on Duri Rd near the Lions Park in Tamworth early in the morning. This is their way of saying “thank you Australia” for giving us a new home. It was a great community atmosphere as we worked together.

Refugee Week

NSS worked in collaboration with Tamworth Regional Council (Cultural Development) in organising a week long calendar to celebrate Refugee Week. This included the showing of the film ‘Constance on the Edge’ followed by a well-attended community forum on the 17th June 2017. Next on the 24th June, our guest speaker was a former refugee from Cambodia, and she spoke about her traumatic experience as a young girl fleeing from the onslaught of the Khmer Rouge. On this same occasion, the newly arrived Karen refugees got a chance to meet and greet the Mayor of Tamworth whilst the Friendship Knitting Group presented them with three lovingly hand knitted rugs.

NSS Marquee at Fiesta La Peel (October 2016)

NORTHERN SETTLEMENT SERVICES LIMITED

NS

Providing support services for migrants & refugees in Newcastle, the Hunter, Central Coast & New England areas.

Free Call:
1800 813 205

mail: nss@nssservices.com.au
web: www.nssservices.com.au



Settlement Services Program - Newcastle

Lydia Manusiu Funded by Department of Social Services through the NSW Settlement Partnership

Project Target Group(s)

Eligible newly arrived people from migrant, refugee and humanitarian backgrounds in the first 5 years of their settlement in Australia.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle.

Project Brief

The Settlement Service Program (SSP) aims to increase independence, knowledge, and ability for humanitarian and refugee entrants and eligible new arrivals, to navigate and access mainstream services and promote self-reliance in the Newcastle SSD. Eligible clients who have resided in Australia for less than 5 years are supported in their settlement by casework and coordination, information and referrals, advocacy, information sessions, promotion, settlement support groups, community development, networking and mentoring.

Highlights and Achievements

78 new clients were referred to the Senior Settlement Worker this financial year, with a total of 115 families supported. Clients came from

Armenia, China, Congo, Ethiopia, Eritrea, Iraq, Iran, Mozambique, Papua New Guinea, Sudan, Syria, Thailand and Tibet. 85% of service users in the Newcastle region have been from Afghanistan and have arrived on humanitarian visas.

Main casework issues identified have been housing issues, family and domestic violence, engagement with National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS), employment, citizenship, utility providers targeting refugees with contracts they cannot afford, financial support and immigration.

Afghan Women's Social Group was held at Jesmond Neighbourhood Centre in partnership with Connectability. NSS manages and facilitates the group with involvement from both the Settlement and Welfare Teams. This group is held on the last Wednesday of each month. The group continues to grow in strength with approximately 15 to 20 women and 15 to 25 children in attendance at each session. We have had presentations from:

- Multicultural Health Unit discussing Women's Health and Domestic Violence
- Multicultural Disability Advocacy Agency presented on Accessing NDIS

- Held consultations with the women about Disability and the NDIS
- Young Healthy Minds about youth and family support
- Interrelate about Relationship Support.
- Multicultural Mental Health Unit on Pregnancy and Alcohol and General Women's Health Issues.
- Information session on Census
- In School Holidays the program focused on the children

In total there are 55 women registered and 20 to 30 children with 9 sessions held in the year.

Outcomes for the participants have included decreased social isolation, improved conversational English and increased knowledge of services and supports in the area.



Group trip to Hunter Ice Skating Stadium in 2016

The Multicultural Female Youth Group was developed to cater to the growing number of isolated Afghan young women in the Newcastle region. The group was managed and facilitated by NSS, and ran every fortnight at Jesmond Neighbourhood Centre. The group slowly grew to include young women in the SSP that were from other countries such as Congo, Sudan and Iran. Activities centred on arts and crafts while having

conversations around a range of issues the group were encountering as they adjusted to Australian life. Some of the needs identified in those conversations led to running relevant information sessions from other service providers including NSW Police and Multicultural Health Unit, and excursions to places such as the Hunter Ice Skating Stadium. The group finished up in September 2016 when the swimming program commenced, and most of the group were keen to participate in that new program.

The young women benefited from becoming more independent and self-confident with accessing youth specific programs and services. They have established long lasting friendships and connections that have assisted them in their school life and social life. Approximately 10 young women attended over 11 sessions.

The Multicultural Women Computer Class & NSS Parenting Group was developed after several concerns were raised with the

lack of knowledge of basic computer skills needed for everyday living. This group was held once a week at Zara's House in Jesmond to make it accessible to the mothers. Many participants had children so a child-minding station was created adjacent to the computer class. Parenting



Afghan young women holding a stall at Unity in Diversity Festival in 2016

support and training components were added to the child care program when the parents were not busy with the computers, as women asked questions of the facilitator, or input was organised. NSS was the lead agency that managed and provided the volunteer teacher with support from Refugees and Partners, Abilitylinks St Vincent De Paul and NSW TAFE.

The women gained an increased knowledge of computers which will assist them with their everyday life. From the parenting component the women gained more understanding of Australian family and parenting practices.

There were 14 women and 8 children over 15 sessions. The women came from Afghanistan, Iran, Congo and Eritrea.

Nippers Program for Afghan Young Women – In late 2016 NSS consulted with a group of Afghan young women and recruited some of them to participate in a Nippers like program with Newcastle Surf Lifesaving after interest from a local business owner to

fund the project. The project ran for 3 months. 4 young Afghan women participated.

The young women gained a better understanding of what is involved in a surf lifesaving club, gained connections with local social group and greater awareness of beach safety. Events and Interagencies involved with 2016-17:

- Refugee Week 2017
- March 2017 Harmony Day in Jesmond
- NSS & Navitas English Census Day
- Multicultural Expo
- Maitland Riverlights Multicultural Festival
- NSS Syrian Information Session
- Unity in Diversity Festival
- Hunter Multicultural Youth Workers Network
- Multicultural Community Drug and Alcohol Team (CDAT)
- Hunter Refugee Network
- Youth Multicultural Welcome Ride
- Newcastle Multicultural Interagency

Settlement Support Worker Lydia Manusiu and Multicultural Families Worker Miza Torlakovic at Harmony Day festivities



Settlement Services Program Volunteer Program – Welfare

Lena Alameddine
Settlement Life Skills

Funded by
Department of Social Services through the
NSW Settlement Partnership

Project Target Group(s)

Eligible newly arrived people from migrant, refugee and humanitarian backgrounds in the first 5 years of their settlement in Australia.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle.

Project Brief

The main purpose of this program is to register and coordinate volunteers from the wider Newcastle area to provide life skills support to clients to assist in their settlement, in particular English literacy, citizenship preparation and driving supervision support, as well as child care and playgroup assistance for group activities.

Highlights and Achievements

Numbers of Clients and Volunteers Involved in the Program

- 60 clients received volunteer support during this financial year
- Over 65 volunteers participate in this volunteer program in this financial year

Outcomes included

- 10 clients received their driving license
- 5 clients received their citizenship

Clients benefited from the support of NSS volunteers in many ways, shown in client's increased awareness and understanding of road rules, progression in English Literacy, increased confidence speaking the English Language, greater understanding of the Citizenship test and Australian culture, systems and rules. In addition to these benefits, the sense of belonging that clients experience in the Australian community is enhanced through their relationships with their volunteers.

Volunteer Support and Development

NSS provided a number of opportunities for volunteers to provide feedback, support each other and develop skills relevant to their volunteering role. For instance, NSS organised a citizenship volunteer meet-up for volunteers to discuss experiences and share strategies.

NSS hosted a volunteer focus group to give volunteers the opportunity to discuss their roles, shares experiences and suggest feedback to the program.

NSS also organised a driving supervisor workshop for driving supervision volunteers. Helping learner drivers

become safe drivers was presented by and Roads and Maritime Services representative.



NSS volunteers enjoyed a Christmas Dinner to celebrate a successful year of volunteering



Volunteer Week 2017 NSS Morning Tea with volunteers proudly displaying their certificates

Settlement Services Program and Pathways to Volunteering

Abby Tinlin

Funded by

Department of Social Services through the
NSW Settlement Partnership,
Multicultural NSW, Unity Grant

Project Target Group(s)

Eligible newly arrived people from migrant, refugee and humanitarian backgrounds in the first 5 years of their settlement in Australia. Pathways to Volunteering – the multicultural community

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Settlement Services Program (SSP) - Newcastle Region.

Pathways to Volunteering - Central Coast, Newcastle, Hunter.

Project Brief

Support and develop the multicultural youth programs, especially supporting the participation of young women; reviewing and updating volunteer policies and procedures of NSS and the Settlement Program; promoting and facilitating the engagement of multicultural community members in volunteering in the local community.

Young Women's Swimming Program

In October-December 2016 and February- March 2017 NSS and NSW Sport & Recreation ran two 8 week young women's swimming programs. These were held at the Wallsend Swimming Centre. Lessons were provided by Lane 4 Aquatics.



The lessons were broken up into two groups - one for girls aged between 6 and 11 years and the other for young women aged 12 to 24. The participants came from a variety of countries, including Afghanistan, Democratic Republic of Congo, Syria, Sudan, Senegal and Ethiopia.

39 young girls and women participated in the two programs.

NSS staff promoted the program, assisted in the registration of participants, provided transportation for young women requiring transport home and held a presentation and BBQ for all the participants and their families.

This program gave girls and young women the opportunity to learn to swim as well as gain a greater understanding of water safety and awareness of Australian pool rules. A key continuing outcome of this program has been greater participation of these girls and their

families in Australian beach and swimming culture, for example, one family reported feeling more comfortable going to the beach and pool in the school holidays.

Welcome Ride January 2017

NSS was a partner in a school holiday program in January 2017 - called 'Welcome Ride' with the Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre (MNC), Navitas English, Catholic Care Refugee Hub, Wesley Mission, Headspace, Northlake's Youth Project, NSW Service for the Treatment And Rehabilitation of Torture and Trauma Survivors (STARTTS) and Samaritans. NSS was involved in the organising the Welcome Ride and provided supervision support on the day. This January event was the second time the 'Welcome Ride' was run, with the goal of linking young people to low cost, local recreational activities.

The January Welcome Ride was a pool party for youth. The day included free pool entry for young people aged 12-18 years, food, DJ, free access to the slide and pool games. More than 60 young people attended.

This holiday program gave young people an opportunity to hang out in a safe and fun environment together. The January Welcome Ride also was an education opportunity for young people in relation to water safety and Australian pool rules and pool etiquette.

SSP Multicultural Youth Group

NSS worked in partnership with STARTTS (lead agency), MNC, Catholic Care Refugee Hub, Headspace and

Northlake's Youth Project commenced a weekly Multicultural Youth Group this year, for youth aged 12-24.

The Youth Group is held every Wednesday during school terms at Jesmond Callaghan Senior campus and runs indoor and outdoor activities, providing a safe recreation area for young people.

Approximately 25-30 young people attend each week. These young people have come from various schools, suburbs and countries, including Afghanistan, Syria, Turkey, Democratic Republic of Congo and Burundi.

NSS attends and supported every week and contributed to the organising of activities and food.

The Multicultural Youth Group has given young people the opportunity to meet other young people outside school in a safe environment. The regular group has resulted in the building of more and closer friendships among the young people.

Through the Youth Group, the young people also have a greater awareness of youth service providers and other available youth activities, for example, the Welcome Ride and youth camps.

Volunteer Policy Project

Due to the significance of NSS volunteer programs to the work of NSS and the demand of volunteer inquiries in our volunteer programs, it is important to have robust processes in place.

NSS sought to review internal processes for the recruitment and management of NSS volunteers.

Pathways to Volunteering

In 2017 NSS was successful in obtaining a Multicultural NSW Unity Grant to increase volunteering pathways for refugees and migrants in our local area. The project is promoting and facilitating pathways for members of CALD communities to get involved in volunteering with organisations.

Through volunteering CALD community members will gain skills and confidence to assist in their employability, their engagement in the local community and their capacity to contribute to the Australian society.

The project was promoted through various networks - TAFE SEE English classes, the Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre English

Classes, and through community. NSS liaised with and linked members of the community to various local organisations, including the Hunter Volunteer Centre, Hunter Wetlands, Newcastle City Council, Community Kitchens and Newcastle Museum.

The project focused on facilitating tailored volunteering opportunities for individual community members.

An example of a successful pathway to volunteering involved a woman who has overseas qualifications and experience in environmental science. She was interested in utilising her skills and knowledge through volunteering, to help the community and gain work experience and contacts in Australia. She was linked through this project, to the Hunter Wetlands Centre, which was looking to start a project that would specially benefit from her particular skills and experience.

Settlement Services Program - Newcastle

Marie Zawadi Funded by Department of Social Services through the NSW Settlement Partnership

Project Target Group(s)

Eligible newly arrived people from migrant, refugee and humanitarian backgrounds in the first 5 years of their settlement in Australia.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle.

Project Brief

The Settlement Services Program (SSP) aims to increase independence, knowledge and ability for humanitarian entrants and new arrivals to navigate and access mainstream services and promote self-reliance in the Newcastle region. People are supported in their settlement through casework, information, referrals, advocacy, information sessions, promotion, settlement groups, networking and mentoring.

Highlights and Achievements

The Settlement Worker worked with people who came from; Burundi, Democratic Republic of Congo, Ethiopia, Eritrea, South Sudan, Guinea, Liberia, Zimbabwe and Mozambique.

Through the period of July 2016 to June 2017 there have been 55 clients registered under the program. There have been 87 casework session and 74 referrals internally and externally.

A significant issue for some in this client group has been the accumulation of Centrelink debts because of their work with Family Day Care and not fully understanding their obligations to report income to Centrelink as well as the Australian Tax Office. The NSS Settlement Worker assisted clients with understanding and arranging debt repayment, and information about their reporting obligations to these two government agencies into the future.

Main areas for the caseworker have been around tenancy and accommodation, financial issues, family violence, support with the citizenship application process, education and employment.

NSS negotiated with TAFE NSW to organise a Food Safety Supervisor Certificate program. 19 clients undertook the training and now have the opportunity to sell food to different markets. Women involved included from the Congolese Umoja Group, South Sudanese Women and other African Women's Groups.

Eleven African women have successfully passed their driving test and received their NSW licence as a result of volunteer driving support from NSS.

We again referred clients to the The Smith Family Saver plus Program (4 sessions). This was the seventh group to complete the program and included 14 clients from the Congolese, Burundi, Rwandan and Ethiopia Community.

The project linked and assisted 12 African leaders with Ability Links for training through the National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS) community engagement program. The group graduated as Community Advisors with improved awareness and understanding of the NDIS, and

knowledge of different organisations who provide services to people who live with a disability.

The project assisted and supported African communities to participate in community cultural events including Riverlights, Harmony Day, Refugee Week and Africa Day at Islington Public School 2017. We continued to work with and support women's groups and community associations from all the African communities.

The NSS Settlement Worker was a valued panellist at the Constance on the Edge movie screening at Tighes Hill TAFE, and shared her own journey and her work with others of refugee background who are seeking to belong in our Newcastle community.



Settlement Worker Marie attending the Africa Day cultural event.

Settlement Services Program - Arabic Speaking Settlement Worker

Lena Alameddine,

Funded by

**Department of Social Services through the
NSW Settlement Partnership**

Project Target Group(s)

Eligible newly arrived people from migrant, refugee and humanitarian backgrounds in the first 5 years of their settlement in Australia – with a focus on Iraqi and Syrian refugee community.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle.

Project Brief

The main purpose of this program is to assist Syrian and Iraqi refugees to navigate access mainstream services and promote self-reliance in the region and a sense of belonging. We provide this support through casework, coordination, information sessions, advocacy, support groups, networking, referrals, mentoring and community building. The main focus of casework has been in housing, financial management, employment and small business setup, family violence, National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS) access and documentation support. This Arabic speaking role commenced in February 2017.

Highlights and Achievements

Syrian and Iraqi Families

26 new arrivals Syrian and Iraqi refugee families were referred to Northern Settlement Services by 30 June 2017.

Initial interviews were conducted with each family to identify the immediate settlement needs with which they wanted support. Most of these new arrivals families are very poor in English language and rely on the Arabic speaking caseworker's language skills to assist them to address their daily settlement issues including paying bills, dealing with real estate agents, health appointments and so on.

Clients are now more aware of services available to support them and have gained more knowledge on how to budget for their financial payments in an Australian context.

Arabic Speaking Women's Group

The Arabic Speaking Women's Group commenced in May 2017 at Jesmond Park Uniting Church on Thursday. The group meets fortnightly and is run by NSS in partnership with Navitas English to support the Syrian, Iraqi and Kurdish women. In the group they have been addressing a wide range of topics to make their settlement easier. These include information about schools,

parenting, accessing Translating Interpreters Service (TIS) interpreters, immigration and Australian law and policies. Child care is provided at the venue to allow women with small children to attend. There are 10 women and 10 children attend the group fortnightly.

Housing Support and Advocacy

Housing and tenancy issues have been significant for the Syrian and Iraqi community with poor English being a factor as well as limited understanding of Australian systems. NSS has negotiated with real estate agents on issues like housing repairs, payment of rent and water bills, lease renewals and issues.

Several families have had difficulties with one real estate agent who has failed to provide basic services and failed to make significant repairs. NSS has engaged the support of the Hunter Tenants Advocacy Service to address these issues.

One family gained a resolution through conciliation at the Tenancy Tribunal where they agreed to pay some of the bond money and break their lease and this family moved to Sydney. Other cases were ongoing at the end of the financial year.

The families have gained greater knowledge of tenancy law in Australia, understanding the process of renting a house or dealing with their real estate agent regards their housing or tenancy issues though the process of responding to these issues.

Financial Support and Employment

The Arabic speaking Settlement Worker provided support and advocacy for a number of clients experiencing hardship paying their bills. This involved communicating with financial councillors, negotiations with utilities providers with clients and development of payment plans. Sometimes it included advocacy around unscrupulous utility providers who had signed clients up for contracts they did not understand without using an interpreter. In some cases we were able to successfully negotiate for those contracts to be terminated without penalty.

We also communicated with business people to assist clients developing their small business and attend with them to support them with their first meeting with businesses willing to buy their products.

Settlement Services Program Multicultural Youth Project

Tonkoh Kamara
Funded by
Department of Social Services

Project Target Group(s)

Multicultural Youth.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle, Hunter and Central Coast.

Project Brief

The youth project main objectives are to identify issues affecting young people from new emerging communities, refugee and migrant background, and design and deliver programs and projects that can address these issues in partnership or collaboratively with other settlement service providers.

The project aims to increase CALD youth engagement, participation and taking leadership in programs and projects which will lead to improving their level of access to and networking with service providers, fostering social and civic participation. It involves casework and mentoring as well as group work to achieve these aims.

Highlights and Achievements

The multicultural youth project undertook casework with 115 young people dealing with issues ranging from;

- education and training (traineeships and

apprenticeship), employment and induction support,

- accommodation and youth homelessness,
- driving fines
- utility debts recovery
- youth workforce development orders

Approximately 60 young people gained casual employment and 40 gained permanent employment.

About 400 referrals were made to recruitment and employment service providers, Services NSW, Fair Trading, Department of Human Services and Neighbourhood Centres, private rentals and department of housing for accommodation (bond, rent start etc.), Sport Clubs, PCYC (Police Citizens Youth Club), charity organisations and other service providers.

Youth Cultural Exchange

We organised a Youth Cultural Exchange Program on 21st and 22nd July 2016, taking 20 young people from multicultural backgrounds from Newcastle to visit two schools in Taree and Port Macquarie. These participants were mostly from refugee backgrounds. The program in each school included presentations to a large group of students, small group

discussions among students from different backgrounds and a soccer game. At Taree High School the young people from Newcastle participated in a workshop that forms part of the indigenous / first peoples program at the school. The group stayed overnight at the youth hostel at Port Macquarie where they engaged in a range of formal and informal group building activities on the beach and at the hostel. The program had many outcomes including building the self-confidence, cross cultural relationships and breaking down stereotypes that lead to racism.

Sporting and Recreational Activities

The multicultural youth worker;

- supported youth sporting activities with Simba Football Club and other local soccer clubs, basketball clubs and rugby clubs
- it engaged in building multicultural youth capacity by linking them with the Newcastle United Jets Football Club community programs including Harmony Day and Youth Week 2017
- organised about 200 young people from CALD background to watch the Newcastle United Jets Boxing Day game vs. Wellington Phoenix FC and another 25 youth and multicultural community members to the Newcastle United Jets versus the Perth Glory FC.

School Holiday / Youth Camps

The Multicultural Youth Worker took part in the Welcome Ride activities at Lambton pool on the 18th January 2017 attended by 60 young people in partnership with NSW Service for the Treatment And Rehabilitation of Torture and Trauma Survivors (STARTTS), Wesley Mission, North Lakes Neighbourhood Centre, Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre, Headspace, Catholic Refugee Services and Navitas English. NSS supported the Auburn Diversity Services Youth Exchange program to Newcastle on the 25th January 2017 with 30 young people from CALD backgrounds.

Leadership / Mentoring Training

This year we have been involved in supporting community youth groups, religious and charity groups run by young adults from the multicultural community with how to design, coordinate and deliver programs successfully. This has included mentoring young people about the processes of becoming an incorporated organisation.

Innovative strategies included pairing young people with role models from among their peers for skills and experience on how they got jobs and accessing education; engaging at risk young people in events and activities with good role models from among

Youth Collective visit to Newcastle



their friendship group; and advocating for and negotiating training for job purposes for disengaged young people.

The youth project worker participated in regional and state youth interagency meetings, forums and training. NSS hosted the November 2016 meeting of the Newcastle Youth Interagency as well as regularly attended. We attended the Lake Macquarie Youth Interagency meetings and the Hunter Multicultural Youth Network. NSS regularly attends

the NSW Youth Collective meetings and hosted the November 2016 meeting in Newcastle. The multicultural youth project worker attended meetings of the Multicultural Youth Action Network (MYAN) meetings and participated in the process of developing the now established 'National Youth Settlement Framework', and was instrumental in having the first MYAN meeting in regional NSW on the 16th February 2017 at Hunter TAFE, Newcastle campus.



Clients enjoying the day doing Henna hand painting at Newcastle Harmony Day, Heaton Park Jesmond





Settlement Services Program Volunteer Coordination

**Michael Freund – Homework and Learning Centres
Funded by Department of Social Services through the
NSW Settlement Partnership and
ClubsNSW (ClubGrants)**

Project Target Group(s)

Children and Youth from refugee, humanitarian and migrant backgrounds in their first 5 years of settlement in Australia (and their parents).

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle.

Project Brief

The main purpose of this project is to register and co-ordinate volunteers from the wider Newcastle community to provide educational support for target group clients, through the NSS Homework and Learning Centres program. Volunteers assist students to develop their English literacy, other academic and social skills, and to complete homework & assignment tasks in a range of school subjects - thus contributing to their achievement of educational milestones at an equitable level with mainstream students.

A total of 6 NSS staff roles were employed by the program during 2016-2017. Project Manager, Michael Freund was responsible for the overall successful operation including; promotion, recruitment and administration of clearances for the large intake of volunteers. A part-time

staff Coordinator at each Homework and Learning Centre managed the class of students & volunteers and liaised with the project manager and school's EALD (English as an Additional Language or Dialect) teacher on a weekly basis.

Coordinators for 2017: Alex McPherson (Islington); David Conway (Jesmond); Bridie Scott (Jesmond Assistant); Josephine O'Hara (Heaton); Jessica Bagnall (Waratah).

Each Centre operated on one afternoon per week during school terms, in a classroom or library venue. Primary schools implemented a roster of fun learning activities in small groups and Secondary schools had one-to-one tutoring. Each Centre had an enrolment limit (10-15 students) to maintain the high quality of support. Smaller Study Groups (5-10 students) operated at the two senior schools.

Highlights and Achievements

Partner Schools and Client Groups

NSS is proud to report that our Homework and Learning Centres program commenced its 12th consecutive year of operation in 2017. During the 2016-2017 reporting period the program partnered with a total of 7 local schools: Islington Primary School, Jesmond Primary School,

Heaton Primary School, San Clemente High School*, Waratah Technology Campus, Jesmond Senior Campus, St. Francis Xavier's College.

**Our long-running partnership with San Clemente was brought to a close after 9 successful years (2008-2016). This enabled a new Learning Centre to be established at Heaton Primary School to meet the need of supporting the school's Syrian refugee children. Large numbers of Syrian students participated for the first time in all three primary school centres. The program also supported target group students from: Afghanistan, Iraq, Democratic Republic of Congo, Ethiopia, India, Nepal, and Thailand.*

Highlights/Achievements:

Quantitative Outcomes

Over 70 school students were enrolled in the program during each half-year in the 2016-2017 reporting period. All students were formally referred by EALD teachers and parents signed permission forms at enrolment and registration days. Over 110 volunteers participated in the program during the period, as NSS benefitted from its continuing partnerships with volunteering services at The University of Newcastle (Teach Outreach, iLEAD Plus, Careers Service). Our volunteer workforce also comprised retired school teachers and working people having a variety of ESL & tutoring skills.

A total of 176 tutoring sessions were delivered in the period.

Qualitative Outcomes

EALD Teachers reported many

benefits for their students who participated in our program, including: completing more tasks; better quality work and results; improved confidence



NSS Learning Centre at Islington Primary School

and participation in class activities; better behaviour and less issues at school; increased participation overall in school-wide activities, such as applying for school captain or prefect and active involvement in event days.

Our centres provided a relaxed space for refugee & migrant students to interact socially with volunteers, e.g. Harmony Day activities and end of term parties, helping to build the students' social confidence and to promote inclusion and participation in the wider Newcastle community. This program also allowed students and parents to better recognise the breadth and integration of support services provided by the NSS Settlement Team e.g. casework and



**NSS Learning Centre at Heaton Primary School
(new in 2017)**

family support, youth work, events, etc.

Volunteer Recognition

NSS recognised and celebrated the hard work and dedication of all its volunteers by organising a special Morning Tea in Volunteer Week and various end of year functions.

Jennifer Cook and Anne Wilson, who have each served in Settlement programs for over 5 years, were finalists in the Hunter Region NSW Volunteer of the Year Awards 2016.



Settlement Services Program - Central Coast

Nellie Srisurapon

Funded by

Department of Social Services through the

NSW Settlement Partnership

Project Target Group(s)

Eligible newly arrived people from migrant, refugee and humanitarian backgrounds in the first 5 years of their settlement in Australia.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Central Coast region.

Project Brief

The Settlement Program of the Central Coast provides short term casework, group work, advocacy and referral to eligible target service users. The program promotes social inclusion and participation through community development programs and activities. The program also raises awareness of the local demographics, challenges and cultural sensitivities of the local CALD communities through cultural competency training and consultation to service providers. Promotion of NSS and its services occurs frequently to the community and to services through agency visits and network meetings. Through the Central Coast Settlement Program, NSS also convenes the Central Coast Multicultural Interagency.

Highlights and Achievements

Casework and Referral

In 2016-2017 the most frequently presenting issue was family and domestic violence (DV), followed by the need for financial, housing and legal assistance. The Central Coast has high numbers of people arriving on family stream visas, and due to the geographical layout of the Central Coast isolation and transport availability can be an issue and a settlement challenge for the CALD community. These challenges also make it difficult to access employment and education pathways.

The Program delivered:

- Over 230 sessions of casework services to people representing 27 cultural backgrounds. Casework may range from one face to face contact to multiple contacts and referrals.
- Filed 11 Child Protection Reports to FACS.
- Made appropriate referrals to 39 local and regional services and agencies, including the Domestic Violence helpline.
- Provided 109 instances of outreach assistance.
- Accessed an accredited interpreter on 37 occasions.

- Case conference support and cross-cultural information.
- 1780 instances of electronic information to the CALD community.

Advocacy

The program provided support and advocacy to the CALD community by addressing both individual needs and, as the needs arise, in a specific ethnic community or the general CALD community. The program has established close working networks and relationships with key services and agencies especially those with multicultural specific programs, such as the local Health District, TAFE, Interrelate, Domestic Violence Court Advocacy Service (DVCAS), Central Coast Disability Network (CCDN) and Ability Links. These collaborations and partnerships have organised and provided community workshops and information sessions.

The Central Coast Settlement Program Represented NSS at:

- **17 agency visits**
These visits were to raise awareness of the NSS programs to outside agency staff and also to promote NSS service to their service users. The program also visited local schools and met with English as an Additional Language or Dialect (EALD) students and their parents as well as visiting TAFE community service students at various campuses.
- **34 external meetings**
The Settlement Program has been involved in the Central

Coast Domestic Violence Committee for many years and is an active member of their DV CALD subcommittee. The program has also provided expertise and local demographic and cross cultural information to various other projects and resources that both government and non-government organisations are delivering and implementing, such as drug and alcohol resources for youth, easy to read factsheets for services.

- **12 interagency meetings**
The NSS Central Coast Settlement Program convenes the Central Coast Multicultural Interagency (CCMI). Agenda and minutes are distributed along with information on settlement news, services and activities. The CCMI organises annual workshops for the community to raise awareness of the Use of an Interpreter, as well as organising the Multicultural Expo. In 2016 in its 11th year the Multicultural Expo focused on the theme “Know Your Rights”.

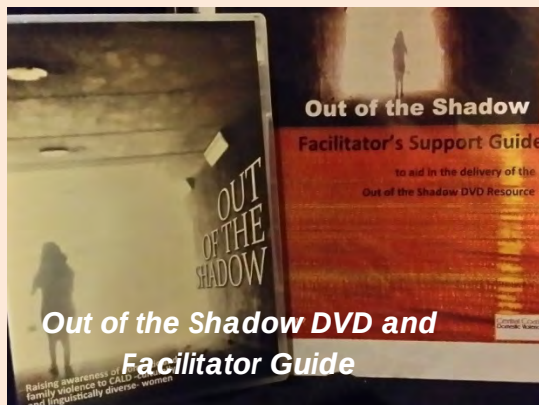
Special Project:

‘Out of the Shadow.....Raising Awareness of Domestic Violence’

This year saw the Settlement Program provide extensive input to the Out of the Shadow Facilitator Guide. This guide accompanies the DVD resource, Out of the Shadow. These resources raise awareness of the forms of Domestic and Family Violence and

their specific expression in the CALD community.

In partnership with other members of the Central Coast DV CALD subcommittee, the program provided workshops to services providers on the delivery of the resource to potential CALD target groups. The resource was also featured in the New South Wales Settlement Partnership (NSP) newsletter and was presented to the Hunter Central Coast Regional Advisory Council of Multicultural NSW.



Out of the Shadow DVD and Facilitator Guide

Talking Around the World

This weekly English conversation class, funded through Central Coast Council, provides a relaxed environment to practice English skills and to also learn of other cultures and traditions by exchanging information on set topics. 63 community members accessed the service, with 19 children accessing the crèche facility. Experienced NSS registered volunteers assist with tuition while a qualified childcare worker provides a variety of educational activities for the children.

The program is popular and word of mouth has been the best promotion. Participants are able to make new friends and learn of local activities and events while also having the provision of settlement information and support.



Students in a group session with Julie our NSS volunteer, on the right



Children listening to a story from an NSS volunteer.

Settlement & Community Team - Playing Around the World (PAW) Central Coast

Natalia Meliendrez

**Funded by Benevolent Society,
with additional resources from NSW Department of Education**

Project Target Group(s)

Families from CALD backgrounds.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Central Coast region.

Groups running at Lisarow, Narara, Blue Haven and The Entrance.

Project Brief

The objective of Playing Around the World (PAW) is to bring families together to share ideas, experience friendship and give children the opportunity to learn through play. Sessions focus on the culture, festivals and traditions of different countries.

Cultural background materials have been produced for children to cover areas such as free play, craft, play dough, dance and music, story time, and sensory activities including traditional food and games.

Workers from different organisations attend to promote their services and programs, and run activities to support the mothers and families. Some of the topics covered were; settlement support, healthy cooking class, speech screening, parenting programs,

keeping children safe, preparing for natural disasters, what's on at the Central Coast Council, UNI 4 You, National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS) and budgeting information.

Participation is encouraged in school holidays activities run at Kanwal, The Entrance, Gosford and Lake Munmorah during September, Summer, Easter holidays and a Mum's Pampering Day.

Highlights and Achievements

Playing Around the World sessions are always reaching out into the community. The biggest highlight of the 2016/2017 reporting period was the commencement of a Russian PAW at Narara. Since February 2017 they have been running the first Ethno specific PAW sessions with 2 NSS Russian volunteers helping running the group, where families from a Russian background get together to share activities, stories and group time in Russian.

Another highlight was the PAW session at The Orchards Age Care facility at Lisarow also with 2 NSS volunteers, which also started this year. Families and residents of the Age Care facility attend the PAW sessions and share

craft activities, morning tea, story time and group time. It is great to see the interaction between the residents and the young children doing craft, singing together and even trying to do the actions with the songs. The parents are really happy as most of the children do not have grandparents here in Australia.

PAW at Blue Haven and The Entrance continued with lots of highlights. Ten families enjoyed two excursions to the Opera house during the 2016/2017 report period thanks to work in collaboration with Benevolent Society. We watched "Pete the Sheep" and "Circus 1903" and the families loved it.

Part of our focus for parents and carers at the sessions was to use material from the "Small Talk" and "Parenting Under Pressure (PUP)" parenting programs to help them reflect on and enhance their parenting. Small Talk has given the parents skills for them to model positive conversations around behaviours they want their children to display, for example taking turns, sharing and good table manners. PUP has helped parents identify when they are under pressure and how to take a break when they need time out for themselves.

Numbers for PAW in 2016/2017 -

Narara Sessions: 17 families.

Lisarow Age Care Facility: 12 families and 42 residents.

Blue Haven Sessions: 38 families (in 2 groups)

The Entrance Sessions: 16 families.

Parents representing; Colombia, Peru, Bolivia, India, Ukraine, South Africa, Thailand, United Kingdom (UK), Greece, Indonesia, Hong Kong, Korea, China, Taiwan, Japan, Philippines, New Zealand, Russia, USA and Australia.

With Blue Haven PAW becoming so big we have split the group in two and use two rooms for our program. Blue Haven Schools as Communities have employed a child care worker to support one of those groups and NSS has employed a playgroup assistant to support the other group.

Workers and volunteers at Playing Around the World work as a team to support families and help them to engage with appropriate support through the community.

The PAW coordinator and volunteers in some cases attended several training programs these included; Healthy and Safe training, Parenting Under Pressure Parenting training, update of the First Aid Certificate, Group Leadership workshop and Money Minder. The PAW worker also completed a Certificate IV in Disability and attended a Multicultural Women's Conference and an NDIS forum.

Partnerships

We worked closely with the Multicultural Children's Resource Centre to access multicultural resources for all our groups and activities. These resources are vital to the success of our PAW program.

It is also important to highlight the School as Community Centres at Blue Haven, The Entrance Community



Yarran worker visited Playing Around the World to engaged with the "Mother Goose" program with games, stories and songs.

Centre, Gosford and Narara Community Centre and The Orchards Age Care Facility for the ongoing support with provision of facilities and for support during the sessions.

Many thanks to the NSW Department of Education for funding additional resources for the Lisarow and Narara, Gosford Groups and for funding the Playgroup Assistant at Blue Haven.



Settlement & Community Team – Multicultural Community Development

Pari Batha

**Funded by
NSW Department of Family & Community Services**

Project Target Group(s)

People from CALD communities, focusing on those who are socially and financially disadvantaged.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Central Coast region.

Project Brief

The community development worker works to build the CALD community capacity and social inclusion through events, information sharing, referrals and group programs, and to raise awareness about the Central Coast CALD community. This involves working closely with the CALD community, local community leaders, advocates, service providers and other relevant networks. The Project supports the Central Coast CALD Community to participate in general events and facilitates opportunities for members of the CALD community to share their cultural experiences with the wider Central Coast community.

Highlights and Achievements

Multicultural Cooking Classes

This program assists in connecting CALD communities with the mainstream community by teaching participants how to prepare a variety of cultural foods and sharing in the preparation and consumption of those traditional dishes from different backgrounds. This program undertaken at Green Point Community Centre once a month in partnership with the Centre. The Centre hosted a variety of cooking classes from backgrounds including but not limited to Italian, Fijian, Turkish, Indian, Persian and South American. The project is now so established that Green Point Centre is going to take full responsibility for the Multicultural cooking classes. For the 10 cooking sessions from July 2016 to June 2017 there was an average of 18 people attending each session.

Go Global

This multicultural movie program is a partnership between NSS, Central

Coast Council Youth Services and the CALD community on the second Friday of each month. Each month we show a multicultural movie in the mother language with English subtitles, which is accompanied by multicultural food and multicultural activities or a multicultural display. The food is linked to the cultural background of the movie and is prepared by different local ethnic groups with a small subsidy from the Central Coast Council. The attendees pay \$2.00 to help cover the cost. From July 2016 to June 2017 different groups hosting the program included Indian, Chinese, Filipino, French and Argentinian and as well as a youth focused movie for Youth Week. We had 381 attendee at our Go Global nights with 8 movies.

CALD Domestic Violence (DV) Committee and DV DVD

The Multicultural Community Development Worker is active on the Central Coast CALD DV Committee. There was intensive work this year on filming and completing a DVD and CD about DV for women from multicultural backgrounds.

Central Coast Multicultural Expo

We had a very successful Expo with more than 49 services attending. Leaders of local ethnic groups participated and gave information about their groups to new arrivals to Australia and Central Coast. More than 300 people attended the Multicultural Expo.

Interpreting Workshop

3 Interpreting workshops were organised for TAFE Community

Services students to train them on how use the interpreter service. two workshops were convened with 70 students attending in Gosford and 30 in Wyong. The feedback from the workshops was very positive as most of the students had limited knowledge about interpreting services.

Harmony Day

NSS was involved in organising and carrying out the Harmony Day event hosted by the Central Coast Council in Memorial Park at The Entrance which attracted over 800 people. We also organised a small internal NSS event with our volunteers and 8 of them attended.

Refugee Week

We used the Go Global movie evening to celebrate Refugee week with the screening of Constance on the Edge.

Mapping CALD Community Needs on the Central Coast

One of the biggest achievements of this year is completing the mapping report including collating the results of 264 surveys with individual community members and interviews with the 16 ethnic community leaders from registered ethnic groups. Hopefully the result can assist FACS and other community and government agencies to provide better services to the CALD community on the Central Coast. The Central Coast has growing numbers of CALD community members but they have limited understanding of the services available to support them, and only a few services are working with this community.

Aged Services Reports



Funded

by

Department of Health

and

**NSW Department of Family & Community Services,
Ageing Disability & Home Care**

Aged Services Team



Rasa Bajalis
Aged Services Team
Manager



John Biswas
Sector Support &
Development



Stefanie Maier
Home Care Packages
Coordinator



Lupe Fonua
Home Care Packages
Coordinator



Tima Oto
Multicultural Social Support
Coordinator



Dongmei Zhang
Chinese Social Support
Coordinator



Irene Lupish
Community Visitors Scheme
Coordinator Hunter



Nicky Wright
Community Visitors Scheme
Coordinator Central Coast



Natalia Meliendrez
Multicultural Social Support
Central Coast



Marilín Pérez Cabrera
Multicultural Social Support
Central Coast

Aged Services Manager

Rasa Bajalis

Funded by

Department of Health

Project Scope

NSS is funded to provide a variety of programs offering coordinated supports to older frail people over 65 years from CALD backgrounds wishing to continue living quality and independent lives in their own homes. As well as maintaining social and community connections, overcome loneliness and isolation. NSS strives to maintain high levels of quality and efficiency in service delivery to our vulnerable CALD communities.

Project Target Group(s) Aged care persons over the age of 65 years from CALD backgrounds, younger people with a disability and their carers.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Hunter and Central Coast regions.

Highlights and Achievements

It is with a great sense of pride and pleasure to present the annual report for the Aged Services program. 2016 – 2017 has brought a continuum of changes with the continuation of the Aged Care Reforms. As anticipated, this year has been hectic and exciting due to the fast pace of these reforms. The Aged Care system has undergone significant change in recent years to become more

consumer focussed, market based and sustainable.

NSS has taken all opportunities for growth proffered by the ongoing reforms while firming our niche as a multicultural provider with the highest of quality standards.

This last year has seen the Aged Services Team grow in diversity of programs and staff numbers. NSS was successful in the Commonwealth Home Support Program (CHSP) Growth Funding Round and received funding to establish a Multicultural Flexible In Home Respite (MIHR) Program for the Hunter and the Central Coast.

The Home Care Package (HCP) program continues to embrace game changing reform. February 2017 saw the end of the long established Aged Care Approval Round (ACAR). The first stage of 'Increasing Choice in Home Care' measure was implemented on 27th February 2017. A HCP is assigned to an eligible consumer from a national "pool" of packages managed by 'My Aged Care' (MAC). The total number of packages continues to be capped. MAC will manage a waiting list and the prioritisation process. Packages are portable and unspent funds move with the consumer to the new home care provider.

A highlight and achievement has been the ability for NSS to provide continuity of care to existing consumers who have been re-assessed for a higher level of package, once MAC assigns the higher level to the consumer and provided the consumer chooses to remain with NSS. The coordinators now Case Manage Level 2, 3 and 4 packages. To complement our existing brokerage model, NSS has employed a small team of mostly bi-lingual care support staff who are working across the Hunter Multicultural Respite Service (HMRS), HCP and MIHR programs. NSS are looking to expand and develop this team.

As part of the 2017-2018 Federal Budget, the funding arrangement for the CHSP has now been extended for an additional 2 years until 30 June 2020. The Department of Health will negotiate new funding conditions and a greater focus on supporting independence and wellness from 1 July 2018. The Multicultural Social Support Program continues to be sensitive to the changing demographics of the region and will be connecting with the Arabic speaking community to support a Social Support Service for their seniors.

I would like to thank the NSS Board of Management, CEO Lulu Tantos, Finance, Administration and the

wonderful “A” team for your ongoing support. In spite of the many challenges your direction, support and hard work has enabled the Aged Services program to continue to embrace and adapt to these changes. NSS focusses on supporting clients through this shifting environment and while some of the changes proved challenging, staff rose to this and went to remarkable lengths to support clients through these transitions. Seeing the meaningful difference the program makes to the client’s wellbeing and their lives provides a great deal of job satisfaction.

Home Care Packages (HCP)

Lupe Fonua & Stefanie Maier

**Funded by
Department of Health**



Project Scope

Home Care Packages (HCP) are designed to give support to frail older people in their home. All HCP's are provided on a 'Consumer Directed Care' model which means increased consumer choice and greater flexibility for the care recipient. While each client has their own set of goals, they all have one goal in common: to remain living in their own home for as long as possible. Our service assists clients to achieve that goal, maintain their independence and provide support services where needed.

Project Target Groups

Our services target people over the age of 65 who have been assessed by the Aged Care Assessment Team (ACAT). The majority of our care recipients are from a CALD. However, NSS give support to non CALD clients if we have the capacity to do so.

NSS is a proud provider of Aged Care Services with extensive experience providing services to clients living in the Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Maitland and Port Stephens area.

During the reporting period the program provided support to 72 clients, levels 2, 3 and 4.

Some clients were assigned an interim HCP at a lower level and are placed in the national queue awaiting assignment.

Consumer directed care has given care recipients the opportunity to tailor their HCP to their personal needs.

While domestic assistance, personal care and transport still make up the majority of services we provide, consumers are now including medical and allied health assessments as well as nutrition services into their HCP.

We have been working with clients and their families to utilise their unspent funds in the best way to foster their mobility and well-being.

Highlights and Achievements

The Aged Care Legislation Amendment (Increasing Consumer Choice) Act 2016 (the Amendment Act):

amount (less any exit amount) will be transferred to their new home care provider. Previously, any unspent funds were retained by the provider.

3. Aged Care Assessment Teams approve clients for home care at a specific package level –1, 2, 3 or 4, rather than the previous broad bands of levels



The changes in Stage 1 commenced on 27th of February 2017.

The key changes are:

1. Funding for a home care package follows the client and home care places are no longer allocated to Approved Providers of home care through the Aged Care Approvals Round (ACAR).
2. Clients can change providers and any unspent home care

1/2 or levels 3/4.

4. A national process for assigning home care packages to eligible clients managed by My Aged Care. Prior to 27th of February, eligible consumers needed to find a provider with an available home care package.
5. The process for becoming an approved provider is streamlined and focussed on the ability of the organisation to deliver quality care. Previously,

there were 53 mandatory criteria that needed to be considered in assessing each application, which applicants found time-consuming and difficult to address.

6. Approved provider status no longer lapses after two years.
7. Approved providers can adjust the services they offer to meet demand across different service areas and home care package levels whereas before, approved providers were restricted to the number of home care places they were allocated through the ACAR.

How the Changes Impacted NSS

1. NSS had 42 places allocated through the ACAR. Now, we are

able to accept more clients if we have the capacity to support them.

2. For the first time, we are now managing clients with level 3 and level 4 Home Care Packages. Some of these clients were existing clients who were assigned a higher-level HCP and other are new referrals through MAC.
3. The national process for assigning HCP has had the biggest impact on our clients. Many clients are approved for a high care package but are placed in the queue with no information regarding the waiting period.



Sector Support & Development – Multicultural Access Project Hunter (MAP)

John Biswas

**Funded by the Department of Social Services and
NSW Department of Family and Community Services,
Ageing, Disability and Home Care**

Project Scope

To facilitate equitable access to Commonwealth Home Support Program (CHSP) for CALD people who are frail aged younger people with disability and their carers.

Project Target Group(s)

Frail aged and younger people with disabilities from CALD backgrounds.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Port Stephens, Upper and Lower Hunter.

Project Brief

- The provision of strategic advice, information, referral and assistance to ethno specific, multicultural and mainstream services to improve outcomes for frail aged, younger people with disability and carers from CALD background.
- Undertake research to identify and report on the needs of frail aged, younger people with a disability and carers from CALD background in the Hunter in the Hunter.
- To participate in CHSP planning processes to ensure services are

responsive to specific need and reflect local demographics.

- Providing information and advice to the CALD communities to increase their awareness and access to appropriate CHSP support services.

Highlights and Achievements

Consultation and Collaboration

MAP worker actively raised CALD issues and unmet needs in the following consultations and forums in relation to the Aged Care issues:

- The project contributed to the MAP joint network submission to the National Ageing and Aged Care Strategy review for people from CALD backgrounds.
- Aged and Community Care Services Forum for Newcastle and Lake Macquarie Hunter Valley Community Care Access Forum.
- NSW Community Care Issues Forum.
- Newcastle Lake Macquarie Community Care Network Forum and Elder Abuse Prevention Collaborative Forum.

- The project also took part in consultations and represented regional issues with the Department of Health, Partners In Culturally Appropriate Care (PICAC) NSW, Sector Support and Development Officer Network and Age & Community Services forums.
- MAP worker also participated and contributed to PICAC CALDWays 2016 conference and attended CALDWays conference 2017.
- Participation in Hunter Rural Multicultural Network, Newcastle Multicultural Interagency and Refugee Network meetings.

In 2016 the project led consultation with Ethnic Communities Council (ECC) NSW and their regional counterpart Hunter Multicultural Communities Inc. to initiate the establishment of the Hunter CALD Elder Abuse Prevention Group which morphed into the Hunter CALD Elder Abuse Prevention Network. In partnership with Elder Abuse Helpline and Resource Unit, Senior Rights Services, Multicultural Health Services-HNEHealth, Sector Support Development Officer (SSDO) - Wesley, NSW Police, Multicultural Disability Advocacy Association (MDAA) and Central Coast & Hunter Elder Abuse Collaborative, PHN Hunter New England and Central Coast, the Network has undertaken numerous consultations with stakeholders to facilitate sector collaboration and Elder Abuse Prevention campaign.

MAP Project participated with Elder Abuse Helpline and Resource Unit to help develop strategies and resources useful to CALD communities regarding the identification and response to instance of elder abuse.

The project facilitated the launch of the Hunter CALD Elder Abuse Prevention Campaign "Everyone Deserves Respect" in May 2017 at NSS, with NSW Minister for Mental Health, Women and Ageing, The Hon. Tanya Davies MP and Parliamentary Secretary for Planning for Hunter Central Coast, Scot McDonald.

The project has delivered CALD specific community conversations on elder abuse as part of the CALD Elder Abuse Prevention campaign to Chinese, Filipino, Tongan, Spanish, Samoan, Spanish, and Vietnamese communities.

During the reporting year links were established with Central Coast Hunter New England Primary Health Network (PHN) to improve the access of CALD communities particularly those who are aged, with a disability, women and children to Primary Care, with the aim of better health outcomes for CALD communities. The main activities identified to achieve this included:

- Increased understanding and use of Translating Interpreting Service (TIS) by Primary Care Clinicians and staff - Cultural Policy in General Practice.
- Improved recording of patient's ethnicity in general practice.

MAP continues to convene the Hunter CALD Disability Reference Group. The

project worker provided both direct support and strategic advice to CALD Community Engagement Project through Hunter CALD Disability Engagement Reference sub-group and participation in the community advisor's workshops for Chinese, Arabic and Filipino groups.

The project facilitated and assisted in the joint production of a promotional film on the CALD Disability Engagement Project as well as CALD Community Advisor Graduation Ceremony. The event was the highlight and celebration of the work of this project. It was attended by the NSW Minister for Disabilities John Ajaka MP as well as local MP's; the launch was held at NSS Hamilton office.

Service Support, Training and Development

The project worker delivered information sessions on My Age Care (MAC) including use of interpreters, advocacy and complaints to Multicultural Social Support Service (MSSS) groups.

The project delivered 6 workshops on cultural responsiveness and effective use of interpreters to 73 support staff from different age care and disability providers from Hunter.

MAP represented NSS at Harmony Day ceremonies in Lake Macquarie, Singleton and Cessnock, Hunter Multicultural Expo and Volunteering Expo.

The Broadband for Seniors programme continues to be delivered with assistance from volunteers under this project.

The MAP project participated in the consultation "Belonging in the Hunter Valley". This consultation enabled stakeholders including Department of Human Services and Council representatives to hear about the access issues for CALD communities around a broad range of issues including health, ageing, transport and disability.





CALD Elder Abuse Prevention Network



Ministers Tanya Davies, Tim Crakanthorp, Parliamentary Secretary Scot MacDonald and NSS CEO Lulu Tantos at the Hunter CALD Elder Abuse Launch



*Chinese dancers performing at the
Seniors Week celebrations*

Hunter Multicultural Respite Service

Lupe Fonua Funded by Department of Health

Project Scope

Provides Respite Care for frail older people over 65 and people with dementia from CALD backgrounds experiencing difficulty in accessing or maintaining participation in Day Care Centre activities.

Project Target Group(s)

People over 65 years from CALD background and their carers.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Port Stephens Upper and Lower Hunter.

Project Brief

The aim of the program is to provide a caring, high quality support that recognises and respects the rights, needs and dignity of each individual. This enables the family and other primary carers with respite in their role. Carers are also supported with monthly 'Carers Dementia Support Group' meetings. NSS providing guest speakers, outings and an environment to share experiences. The ratio is 1 care support worker to 4 clients who assist clients to participate in the activities of the day care centre.

Highlights and Achievements

Day Care Centres

During the reporting period NSS employed our own Direct Care Support staff. They now attend all seven (7) Day Care Centres, three (3) of which has bi-lingual Care Workers. This has been a positive move as it has enabled more consistency for the client and allowed the program to reach its target. Some of these clients are interacting with Care Workers comfortably in their own language providing support in a timely and safe manner.

29 people regularly attended 7 Day Care Centres.

Dementia Carers Support Group

The project coordinates the monthly meetings of the support group. The members are encouraged to share their experiences with each other in a warm and understanding atmosphere. Several of these carers have a long history of friendship and have developed a strong bond over the years.

The reporting period has seen a lot of activities for the Carers Support Group. The Seniors Week celebration at St Lawrence O'Toole hall with the Multicultural Social Support groups and Premiers Gala Concert in Sydney. A bus trip to see the Barramundi Fish Farm at Bobs Farm. The carers enjoyed a Pamper day (neck/head massage, manicure).

The carers thoroughly enjoyed these outings which gives them a break from their caring roles. Celebrations were held for two of the Carers' birthdays who were both 80+.

The group was visited by guest speakers of interest requested by the carers. Heart Foundation (Heart & Exercise), Dementia Australia (Mind Matters) and the Department of Human Services. (Payments).

10 people regularly attended the 'Carers Dementia Support Group'.

NSS Role

NSS role is to provide a caring, high quality support that recognises and respects the rights, needs and dignity of each individual. Clients enjoy an atmosphere of acceptance and caring for their safety as well as their well-being. The family and other primary carers are also supported and receive respite in their role. The respite service is provided in a way that is appropriate for the client both culturally as well as linguistic needs of particular clients.

Achievements

Day Care Centres

NSS for the first time employed its own Direct Care Support staff to look after all 7 Day Care Centres. This move has assisted in sustaining the viability of this programme long-term into the future.

Five of our Direct Care Staff are bi-lingual. Three Direct Care Staff are matched with Day Care Centres of their own language. This has been a great achievement assisting clients in Centres as more and more clients are reverting back to their own native language. Feedback from coordinators has been very positive.

Dementia Carers Support Group

Socialising and information sharing plays a huge role in this Group. Throughout the year, they have been engaged every month in some form of activity or information session as indicated in the Highlights.

Newcastle Multicultural Support Service Group

Tima Oto

Funded by
Commonwealth Home Support Program,
Department of Health and
NSW Department of Family Community Services
Ageing and Disability and Homecare

Project Scope

To support Culturally and Linguistically Diverse (CALD) groups to socialise in a safe and friendly environment.

Project Target Group(s)

People over 65, from a CALD background.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Upper and Lower Hunter, Port Stephens.

Project Brief

To support the social needs and welfare of frail aged people and younger people with a disability and their carers from CALD backgrounds. To reduce isolation and support social connectedness for those wishing to continue living quality and independent lives in their own homes.

Currently the program is supporting 5 ethno – specific groups including; Vietnamese, Spanish Speaking, Samoan, Filipino and the recently added Tongan community.

Highlights and Achievements

Celebrating Senior Week in March is always the highlight of the year. This year we celebrated Seniors Week at St Lawrence O' Toole Hall at Broadmeadow with the Newcastle Lord Mayor Nuatali Nelmes as our guest. The whole day was enjoyed by all with traditional singing and dancing from the Chinese community, Filipino community and Spanish community. Celebrations included; Line Dancing demonstration and live band which encouraged everyone to join in dancing and others singing Karaoke. Refreshments were provided by NSS and the Filipino Group bringing in some traditional dishes to share. At the end of the day everyone left exhausted with happiness. We were also fortunate to secure Free Tickets for



the Premiers Gala Concert in Sydney. Everyone travelled by train to watch this concert which was quite an experience.

During this reporting year speakers were sourced from Department of Human Services (DHS), Alzheimer's Australia, Red Cross, Elder Abuse, Catherine Henry Lawyers for Power of Attorney issues etc. I would like to mention DHS Belinda Allen for her dedication and assistance in providing much needed information in regard to Portable Pension and Pension Payments in general.

75% of registered clients attended on a regular basis.

At the beginning of each year we have a planning meeting is held with

each group to identify their needs and interests. There is a particular focus on wellness during these planning sessions. Each group has about 6 sessions of information provided by various speakers. The remaining meetings are focussed around special celebrations and events such as Mother's Day, cultural celebrations, Carers Week and Seniors Week.

Bus Trips during this reporting year were enjoyed by everyone, and Cabramatta was a particularly favourite destination among the participants.

There has been a keen interest in digital literacy and the program will be introducing computer classes to complement the existing program.



The Filipino Group consisting of 17 members and is very active with a good turn up every month

Multicultural Social Support Service Central Coast

Natalia Meliendrez and Marilín Pérez Cabrera

Department of Social Services and the NSW Department of Family and Community Services, Ageing, Disability and Home Care

Project Scope

The Multicultural Social Support Service (MSSS) supports CALD people who are frail aged, younger people with a disability and their carers in a safe and friendly environment.

Project Target Group(s)

People over 65 who are frail aged, younger people with a disability and their carers from CALD background.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Central Coast regions.

Project Brief

To support the social needs and welfare of frail aged people, and younger people with a disability and their carers from CALD backgrounds. To reduce isolation and support social connectedness for those wishing to continue living quality and independent lives in their own homes.

Highlights and Achievements

The program supports 120 clients and 25 volunteers. These volunteers provide support to clients and carers. This includes; home visits, telephone calls, taking clients to medical appointments, shopping, banking, etc. Volunteers support clients by taking them to social functions, outings and other events organised by the MSSS Coordinators. The MSSS Coordinators recruit, train and manage volunteers

so that they can provide a good and reliable service to the MSSS clients.

Adequate and up to date training is offered to volunteers during the year and the Coordinators are available to supervise volunteers and advise them on issues that concern them.

Achievements

During the reporting period volunteers attended "Professional Boundaries" and "Supporting people with Dementia" training.

Volunteers attended an appreciation lunch at The Central Coast Leagues Club.

A quarterly MSSS newsletter for volunteers and clients provides them with information about the service, such as relevant Government changes, upcoming training and events.

Clients Monthly Social Days

- **First Wednesday** every second month: Cooking Class has travelled around the world and our clients have had a taste of Italy, Japan, Sweden, Hungary and Indonesia.
- **Second Wednesday:** The General Group has joined with the Woy Woy and Kanwal groups. Presentations included speakers from Fair Trading about "Rights & Scams" and an information session on the "Census".

- **Third Wednesday:** The Spanish Speakers Group meets at Tuggerah Lakes Community Centre, Bateau Bay. Everyone brings a plate of food to share. During this reporting period the group celebrated Chile National Day and Harmony Day. Information sessions were provided on National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS) and Fair Trading presented information on “Rights & Scams”. Outings included lunch at Ourimbah / Lisarow RSL Club, Central Coast Leagues Club, Long Jetty Hotel and The Big Tuna at The Entrance.
- **Every Thursday:** The Woy Woy Group meets at the Peninsula Community Centre, participating in craft, board games and presentations on different countries by a volunteer and by various guest speakers. Outings to restaurants or parks cannot happen without the assistance of the great volunteers.
- **The Kanwal Group** meets at the Lakeland Community Centre. MSSS clients and NSS are thankful to the support of the Benevolent Society which allows NSS to access this venue. The group meets every second Friday and enjoys relaxation and gentle exercise classes, craft, watching documentaries and presentations from various speakers on relevant topics. The volunteers are engaging well with the clients and enjoy participating with the activities. Outings included going out for lunch, attending Art Therapy classes at Bateau Bay Library, Elder Abuse Information Day, Advanced Care Directive information sessions and Wellbeing and Self Care Workshops.

The MSSS has been granted a bequest from a benefactor . This has been used to support the wellness and enablement of the clients with a series of Wellbeing Workshops.



Multicultural Social Support clients on the Central Coast doing heartmoves exercises.



One of the Kanwal Group clients having fun doing stretching exercises.

Chinese Social Support Project

Dongmei Zhang
Funded by
Department of Social Services

Project Scope

The Chinese Social Support Project (CSSP) aims to provide an appropriate social support program to the frail aged persons over 65 years from a Chinese background to encourage social connectedness and reduce isolation.

Project Target Group(s)

The frail older people over 65 from Chinese background.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Maitland and Port Stephens.

Project Brief

Monthly social support groups have been formed at Jesmond Neighbourhood Centre, The Place (Charlestown Community Centre) and The Bruce Community Centre at East Maitland. Activities across these groups include; English conversation class with volunteers (Newcastle), Tai Chi exercises facilitated by a volunteer (Charlestown), information sessions, celebration of special cultural festivals as well as outings. The topics of information sessions included Centrelink updates, financial information services, travel planning, keeping safe, elder abuse, falls prevention. Up to 30th June 2017, there were 48 clients registered with Chinese Social Support Project. 4 new

clients were referred from My Aged Care (MAC). 2 clients moved out of the region and 3 clients moved into the aged care facilities.

Highlights and Achievements

Seniors Week Celebration

During Seniors Week in March 2017, the Chinese seniors joined the other Multicultural Social Support Groups to celebrate the Festival together. Approximately 40 Chinese people including clients, carers and volunteers attended the event. All the clients enjoyed the delicious multicultural food and performances including traditional Chinese dancing, Line dancing, Filipino singing and Spanish Macarena singing and dancing.

Traditional Festivals Celebration

Throughout the whole year, we continued to celebrate the Chinese traditional Festivals with our clients. Chinese New Year, Dragon Boat Festival and Mid-Autumn Festivals are the most important dates for Chinese people. We brought traditional food according to the Festivals and shared with group members together.

Wallsend Library Visiting for Newcastle Group

In July 2017, the Newcastle group went to the Wallsend Library. The librarian presented an introduction on the library activities. They were shown how to access the Chinese resources through the apps etc. The librarian assisted the clients to apply for a library card so they could use the resources from the local libraries. All the clients enjoyed the visit and they would like to come to the library in the future.

Volunteers

Until the end of June 2017, there were 12 registered volunteers. All the volunteers played different but vital roles which included group English conversation class, computer class tutoring, Tai Chi group facilitating, telephone based monitoring

services, one to one English tutoring and transport support to our senior clients. Three training sessions were held both with NSS Community Visitors Scheme and Multicultural Social Support volunteers. The topics included; elder abuse, volunteer rights and responsibilities and MAC reform. During the National Volunteer Week 2017, all present volunteers received a Certificate of Appreciation at an event hosted by Northern Settlement Services. In Dec 2016 a Christmas cruise was organised in appreciation of the wonderful work done by the volunteers.



Chinese Broadband for Seniors class of 2016/17 proudly displaying their certificates.

Community Visitors Scheme (CVS) - Hunter

Irene Lupish

**Funded by
Department of Health**

Project Scope

The Community Visitors Scheme (CVS) provides friendship and companionship by matching aged care recipients with volunteer visitors.

CVS aims:

- To provide visitors to lonely and isolated aged persons of CALD background.
- To enrich the quality of life of those living in residential aged care facility or living at home and are recipient of Home Care Packages.
- To enhance their social contacts and to minimize isolation from the general community.

Project Target Group

Special needs group of aged persons of CALD Aged Care Facility or in their own homes, and in receipt of Home Care Packages (HCP).

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Upper and Lower Hunter including Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Maitland, Cessnock and Port Stephens.

Project Brief

During the reporting period 14 facilities and 12 private homes were visited. 39 residents were regularly visited by our volunteers. Those volunteers made 740 visits and travelled 11,508 kilometres in 2017. Matching appropriate visitors to residents still is a challenge, thus 8 residents are still waiting to be appropriately matched. Our clients come from different backgrounds and speaking different languages.

Currently our clients come from Holland, China, Italy, Ukraine, Russia, Poland, Serbia, Germany, Latvia, South Africa, Greece, Indonesia, Spain, Macedonia, Malta and Australia.

There are 19 registered volunteers for this program, 16 of those are active volunteers. During this reporting period



CVS Volunteers – National Volunteer Week Celebration 2017

4 volunteers have resigned and 6 volunteers were recruited.

New volunteers undergo Police Clearance and participated in orientation session. To date, 18 residents were successfully matched with a volunteer. During this reporting period we have received 10 referrals from residential facility and 8 from Home Care Package providers. As in previous years, training and special events were organised for the volunteers. Special events for the volunteers are recognition of their contribution to the program.

A cruise lunch on Newcastle Harbour was organised in appreciation for the

work done during the year. And morning tea to celebrate National Volunteer Week. Every four months the CVS team will meet for training, interaction and morning tea. Thus year training covered “Elder Abuse”, “Your Rights and Responsibilities” and “Changes in Aged Care Service Delivery”.

Highlights

The Coordinator of this program has attended regional meetings and completed a 3-day course, “Dementia Essentials”. Towards the end of this reporting year a target was met in Home Care Packages fulfilling the funding requirements.

*Community Visitor's Scheme Coordinator
Irene Lupish visiting a client.*



Community Visitors Scheme (CVS) – Central Coast

Nicky Wright

**Funded by
Department of Health**

Project Scope

The Community Visitors Scheme (CVS) provides friendship and companionship by matching aged care recipients with volunteer visitors.

Project Target Group(s)

Over 65 years of age residing in a Residential Aged Care Facility or on a Home Care Packages (HCP) who are from a CALD background, a special needs group or who are socially isolated.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Central Coast region.

Project Brief

CVS is a Commonwealth Government initiative to enrich the lives of older people living in Residential Aged Care Facilities or living at home and are in receipt of a Home Care Package. Volunteer Community Visitors support older people who may be lonely and who would like their own special visitor. CVS improves the quality of life of older people by enhancing their social contacts and by minimizing social isolation from the general community.

It is a free service for eligible clients.

Highlights and Achievements

During the reporting period 22 clients received visits from 14 active

volunteers on the Central Coast. Twenty of these clients within 10 facilities and 2 clients who are recipients 2 HCP providers .

The role of CVS coordinator is to recruit, train and support CVS volunteers.

The CVS Coordinator matches volunteers with older people who are socially isolated for the purpose of friendship and companionship.

The primary objective of the scheme is social – any older person whose quality of life would be improved by the companionship of a community visitor can be referred. The development of the friendship provides an opportunity for the residents to feel a continued sense of belonging with their local community.

The CVS Coordinator is responsible for effectively and efficiently coordinating the CVS Program across the Central Coast area, in accordance with the work plan, the Department of Health guidelines and NSS organisational policies and procedures.

CVS program could not operate without the commitment and support from the many volunteers engaged with the program.

CVS volunteers are appreciated & valued for their contribution to their volunteering role.

The Coordinator provides ongoing training & support for CVS volunteers. During the reporting year the volunteers attended training sessions on “Professional Boundaries” and “Supporting People with Dementia” as well as ongoing support and debriefing opportunities.

Special events for the volunteers are in recognition of their contribution to the program. A lunch was organised at Central Coast Leagues Club in appreciation for the work done during the year. Regular meetings were held during the year for training and social interaction.



New CVS Central Coast Volunteer and Client at the first visit – a positive experience all round!

Multicultural Family Support & Welfare Reports



**Funded
by
NSW Department of
Family & Community Services**

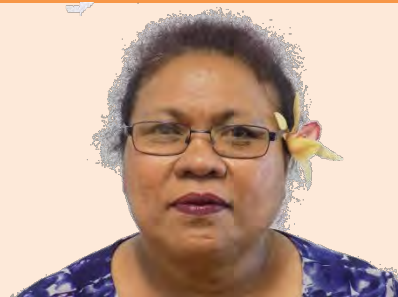
Welfare Team



Petrona Kelly
Welfare Team Manager /
Complex Case



Miza Torlakovic
CALD Family Worker
(Families First)



Juanita Loli
*Multicultural Family Support &
Welfare Coordinator, Tax Help,
EAPA Officer*



Zeni Edmunds
Brighter Futures Coordinator



Elena Ferguson
*Multicultural Family Support &
Welfare Coordinator*

Multicultural Family Support & Welfare

Early Intervention & Placement Prevention (EIPP) Program

**Petrona Kelly (Team Manager), Juanita Purcell-Loli,
Elena Ferguson, Lydia Manusiu, Hayley Bateman**

**Funded by
NSW Department of Family & Community Services**



Project Scope

This support service model is structured to deliver two streams of service provisions

1. Child and Family Support (CFS) targets families with children aged 0 – 12 years or expecting a child.
2. Youth and Family Support (YFS) targets young people under 18 years or families with young people in this age range. Duration of service is three months and can be extended a further three months upon review or to a year if the client is re-assessed as needing continuing service to achieve agreed goals.

Project Target Group(s)

The Early Intervention & Placement Prevention (EIPP) program targets low to medium risk children, young people

and families from CALD backgrounds for short-term support to identified issues to prevent escalations of problems.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Port Stephens with outreach services to locations across the Hunter as capacity allows.

Project Brief

Key service specification of this project include the following:

- Advice and Referral by providing comprehensive information and advice to young people and families.
- Assessment and Case Planning by providing assessment to assess the strengths and needs, including any risks; plan and coordinate a mix of services to meet the needs of client.
- Home Visits delivered to individual family home or another location.
- Parent Support Groups by facilitating self-help/peer support groups for parents

- Parenting skills group by providing structured parenting programs.

Highlights and Achievements

Case Management

- This year, the Welfare Team provided approximately 2900 instances of services to clients. Presenting issues were inter-related and on many occasions a client / family presented a number of needs or problems including; domestic violence, immigration, legal, housing, mental health, income support, police, court matters, family problems, health, social/emotional, supporting letters, tenancy issues, unemployment, youth issues, etc.
- Individuals and families were assisted according to needs. Support was provided through outreach either face to face and through other means such as e-mails, text, phone, etc.
- Clients were provided information, options and advice relevant to their needs and referred to culturally appropriate services either external or to NSS workers.
- Children with child protection issues reduced and young people's level of safety and well-being improved.

- Social isolation and homesickness among the women has been reduced; and a sense of belonging, camaraderie and self-esteem increased through participating in group activities.

Multicultural Playgroups / Parenting Groups

The Welfare Team is responsible in running groups in partnership with other providers:

- MOMS (Mothers' Obstetrics Multicultural Support) with Hunter New England Multicultural Health Services.
- Multicultural Munchkins (Tareeqa Tots) with Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre (MNC).
- NSS Multicultural Parenting Group at Hunter Multicultural Communities.
- Multicultural Supported Playgroup in partnership Kindergarten Union (KU), Mission Australia & MNC.
- NSS Multicultural Playtime Group in partnership with MNC.
- Russian Bicultural Children's Group run in Wallsend.
- Multicultural Playgroup Lake Macquarie in collaboration with Lake Macquarie City Council & The Willows in Warners Bay.

Multicultural Family Support Project – Families First Early Intervention Program

Miza Torlakovic

**Funded by NSW Department of Family and Community
Services, Community Services - Families NSW**



Project Scope

Provide support to vulnerable disadvantaged families comprising of first time parents and families with children aged 0-8 from CALD backgrounds.

Project Target Group(s)

The target group includes teenage parents and parents with a developmental disability and / or parents with other special needs.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle and Lake Macquarie.

Project Brief

Service Delivery / Case Management

107 families accessed the project, of this total, 52 were new clients and 43 families exited the service.

Families came from Iraq, Syria, Afghanistan, Sudan, Burundi, China, Iran, Bangladesh, India, Columbia, Germany, Sudan, Croatia, Mauritania, Bosnia, Qatar, Bolivia, South Korea, Nepal, Jordan, Cambodia, Philippines, Polish, Serbia, Israel, Japan, Indonesia, Thailand, Pakistan, Jordan, Kenya, France and Vietnam.

Referrals come from Hunter Area Health, Centrelink, Family and Community Services, Women's Refuges, Child Care Services, Housing services, TAFE, schools, Navitas, early intervention services as well as through NSS and self- referrals.

691 face to face case contacts were made through centre based activities, home and hospital visits and appointments to and with other agencies / service providers. The area of support provided included parenting practices, health and children's health, mental health, child protection, child care, school issues, family / domestic violence, legal issues, Centrelink, material / financial assistance, accommodation, immigration, learning English, social isolation and assistance with filling forms.

Group and Individual Programs

MOMS Friendship Group

This is a partnership with the Multicultural Health Services. This year 7 Sessions were held on settling babies, kid safety, baby development, mental wellbeing / post-natal exercise, introducing baby food, child speech and language development. 136 people attended including mums, children, babies and family members. Interpreters in Dari / Farsi, Thai, Vietnamese and Korean languages were used.

Multicultural Parenting Group

Throughout the year 10 group activities for CALD parents / carers with children were held on a monthly basis. This group provides information and social support with topics based on parents' requests including; children's activities, women's health, mental health, public transport, Centrelink, Legal Aid - Family Law, healthy relationships, family, yoga, relaxation / meditation. 283 parents, carers and children attended.

Multicultural KU Supported Play Group

27 playgroup sessions with 420 parents / carers and children attending. The families attending reported enjoyed sharing information relevant to their children and making new friends and networking.

North Lake Macquarie Play Time Group

Multicultural Playgroup, based at the Willows, Warners Bay provides a friendly and welcoming place for parents and carers with CALD

backgrounds living in Lake Macquarie area.



Activities for this playgroup include; educational support and resources for parents and carers, storytelling, music, singing, games and craft activities. 17 sessions with 338 parents / carers and children attending every 1st and 3rd Wednesday of the month. Also, families enjoyed regular monthly visits to Speers Point library and we like to thank them for their support.

Afghan Women's Social Group

The Afghan Women's Social Group is a partnership with Jesmond Neighbourhood Centre. The group takes place on the last Wednesday of each month and it is always well attended. We provide educational information sessions, children activities including sporting activities, donations of baby / children's clothes and toys to share as well as social interaction. Over the year NSS held 10 Sessions and 294 parents and children attended.

Community Capacity Building

The partnership with the Hunter New England Multicultural Health Service

continues through a number of programs including Foetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder (FASD) program and Multicultural Mental Health Wellbeing Program. More sessions in both programs are planned for the next twelve months.

The project was involved in an 8 week learn to swim program which was conducted and supported by NSW Sport & Recreation. 39 young girls aged between 6-11 and 12-24 participated in the program came from Afghanistan, Congo, Syria, Sudan, Senegal and Ethiopia.

CALD Family Project participated in numerous community events including; Lake Macquarie Harmony Day, Lake Macquarie "You're Kidding Me Expo" (Glendale), Multicultural Services Expo (Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre) and Hunter Refugee Week.

Networking and Other Forums

Much of the success of this project has been due to its ability to network with other organisations. This offered good client outcomes through the project workers and knowledge about specific services through the various agencies partnerships. Other networking through formal meetings, interagencies and other forums to share information on the target group, make appropriate referrals to familiar services and to develop a strong base on issues that impacted on CALD families clients.

Acknowledgment

The project was strengthened by the support provided by NSW St Vincent the Paul Society, Samaritans, Merewether Uniting Church Community Kitchen Merewether and individuals donating baby /children's clothes and toys.



Multicultural Parents Group - Healthy relationships session

Brighter Futures Program

Early Intervention Program

Zenaida Edmunds

Funded by

**NSW Department of Family & Community Services through
Samaritans Foundation**



Project Target Group(s)

CALD Families with young children (0 – 8) and including pregnant women.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle and Lake Macquarie.

Project Brief

This program provides intensive and preventative support to vulnerable families with young children, where children are identified at risk of significant harm. Parenting support through regular home visits to ensure any family issues that occurs are addressed immediately.

It is voluntary and takes referrals from NSW Family and Community Services (FACS), is delivered by non-government agencies and the lead

agency is Samaritans Foundation and Northern Settlement Services (NSS) is one of the partner agencies. NSS provides the home visiting component of the program to CALD families. Criteria includes; families experiencing domestic violence, drugs and alcohol problems and when one or both parents suffer from mental illness.

Highlights and Achievements

Home Visiting – Brighter Future (BF) Families

This year, seven CALD families qualified to be in the BF Program. Cultural backgrounds include; Indonesian, German, Afghani, Iraqi, Mauritanian, Japanese and Filipino. The support provided is to role model positive parenting, positive interactions within the family establish routine with children, sleeping patterns, prepare healthy and inexpensive meals and referrals to financial counselling if needed, and drug and alcohol counselling and pre-school or child care centre.

On exit from the program, families are empowered to live with minimal support.

Multicultural Playgroup

Operates every Friday during school term.

This is a partnership between NSS and the Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre (MNC) being held at MNC. It is attended by families from different cultural backgrounds and this year, majority are Chinese families and we also have families from Australian backgrounds that live locally. The playgroup activities provides the children with social interactions, enhanced their developments in language, fine motor and gross motor skills. The parents are provided with parenting information and support and social interactions from other parents.

Triple P

Triple P (Positive Parenting Program). The program was presented to five Iranian families. The workshop was conducted at NSS over six sessions.

What was Achieved?

A greater understanding of how to implement positive parenting with young children, including strategies to raise two-year olds and dealing with temper tantrums.

Child Protection Forum

NSS involved in organising a child protection forum to address the issue of child protection in the CALD community. It was attended by FaCS and relevant non- government agencies and CALD specific agencies. The forum aimed to provide information on the different programs and projects that support families and CALD specific support services for families with young children.

The project worker spoke about BF providing intensive support to vulnerable CALD families with young children at risk of significant harm.

What was Achieved?

A greater understanding of the different support services for CALD families with young children and strategies to address issues of child protection in the CALD communities especially in the recent arrived migrants and refugee groups.



Complex Case Support Program

Petrona Kelly
Funded by
Department of Social Services

Project Scope

Complex Case Support (CCS) provides specialised and intensive services to humanitarian entrants with complex and high needs. The program provides flexible, tailored and localised responses to the needs of all individuals in each case.

Project Target Group(s)

The main client group of CCS are:

- Refugee entrants
- Special Humanitarian Program entrants
- Protection Visa holders and persons who hold or may have held a Temporary Protection Visa

Clients are eligible for services for up to 5 years after their arrival in Australia, however flexibility may be shown to this timeframe in exceptional circumstances.

Project Geographical Region(s) and Area(s)

Newcastle and the Hunter Region

Project Brief

CCS is specifically targeted at supporting clients whose needs extend beyond the scope of other settlement services such as the Humanitarian Settlement Services (HSS) and the

Settlement Grants Program (SGP).

CCS is designed to work in partnership with other settlement and mainstream services to address the significant barriers these clients face in settling in Australia.

CCS services may be delivered as short as crisis intervention of up to 14 days or as case management services up to six months.

Complex needs may include:

- Mental health (including torture and trauma)
- Physical health
- Family violence
- Personal, grief or family relationship counselling
- Special services for children and youth
- Support to manage accommodation, financial or legal issues

Referral to CCS with the consent of the client can be done by any organization or person such as service providers funded by the department, commonwealth, state or territory government agencies, community and health organizations, local church and community groups, volunteer groups and self-referrals.

What Happens to a Referral?

The department assesses each referral and decides whether to accept it. Each case that is accepted is allocated to a member of the Humanitarian Services Panel or another contracted service provider for example NSS. The client will be informed that it is accepted.

An Initial Needs Assessment (INA) is completed by the service provider. This is usually done by meeting the client face to face and discussing what they regard as their needs and the information in the referral. An INA may also be requested by the department to assist in deciding whether to accept or decline a referral. This should be done within 3 business days of allocation of the case.

A Case Management Plan (CMP) is developed by the service provider for the case. This should be done within 5 business days of allocation of the case to the services provider

The CMP sets out the activities that will be undertaken to address key issues identified through the referral and needs assessment of the client(s). Once the department agrees to the CMP, the service provider starts delivering the services through a case manager.

Highlights and Achievements

This financial year, NSS delivered services to a family with 4 children and to an individual client.

This was in collaboration with other service providers such as Allied Health

Services, Hunter New England Health, Translating Interpreters Service (TIS), Migrant Health Interpreters, Multicultural Mental Health, Specialised Treating Officers, NSW Service for the Treatment And Rehabilitation of Torture and Trauma Survivors (STARTTS), Hospital Social Workers, NSS Volunteer Program, schools, psychologists, Women & Children's Refuge, Community Housing Services, Real Estate Agencies, Housing NSW, child care service.



What was achieved?

- NSS worked collaboratively with other service providers and professionals involved with client(s) to ensure the best possible outcomes for the client(s).
- A client was able to sit and pass the Citizenship exam, and become employed in his field of expertise.
- Clients were linked to parenting and family support programs
- Educational and vocational opportunities for clients were identified and referrals made.
- Children were linked to education support, sporting and youth activities.

- Clients were able to build their confidence and ability to self-advocate and communicate with services independently.
- Clients were linked to and understand how to access

relevant services after their CCS intervention ceased.



Events that NSS has participated in 2016-17





Lake Macquarie City Council Refugee Welcome BBQ



CVS Coordinator
Irene Lupish and
MSSS Coordinator
Tima O'to at the
Volunteers Expo



Multicultural Broadband for Seniors Class



Arabic Settlement Worker Lena Alameddine with one of our NSS Volunteers at the NSS Volunteers Morning Tea



Some of our NSS Volunteers with NSS Chair Trudy Mills-Evers AM, CEO Lulu Tantos and MSSS Coordinator Tima Oto proudly displaying their certificates at the NSS Volunteers Morning Tea



**NORTHERN SETTLEMENT
SERVICES LIMITED**

HARMONY DAY



Seniors Week Celebrations 2017



Community Advisory Celebration



*Harmony Day Celebrations 2017,
Heaton Park Jesmond*



*Harmony Day festivities at
Heaton Park Jesmond*



Celebrating 10 years anniversary and diversity of the Hunter African Community Council



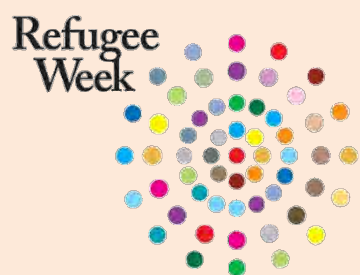
Community Visitors Scheme Coordinator Irene Lupish at the NSS Stall at the Multicultural Expo held at the Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre



Left: NSS staff Elena, Miza and Juanita and NSS Board Member Sania at the "You're Kidding me Expo" at Glendale



Africa Day Celebrations at Islington Public School



Dancing at the Hunter Multicultural Communities celebrating Refugee Week Festival



Immigration Advice & Assistance



Immigration Advice & Assistance

Lulu Tantos, & Henriette de Jong

(Reg.#0318123) (Reg.#1462231)

NSS has been operating a dedicated immigration advice and assistance service for over 20 years to clients in the Newcastle, the Hunter area and in the regional areas of NSW.

Appointments with a Migration Agent are provided via a Skype service to residents of the Central Coast, Orange, Bathurst, Dubbo, Tamworth, Armidale and the mid North Coast.

Immigration law is a complex area with many different visas available depending on clients' circumstances. Our registered Migration Agents provide professional, up to date advice and assistance to ensure that the immigration process goes as smoothly as possible for them.

During the reporting period approximately 700 appointments were made with the Migration Agents and advice and assistance was given in the following visa categories:

- Refugee/Humanitarian
- Partner
- Visitor
- Family Violence Provisions
- Child
- Protection
- Skilled (permanent and temporary), and
- Appeals to the Administrative Appeals Tribunal and the Minister for Immigration and Border Protection

The majority of clients seen were from Syria, applying for humanitarian visas for family members dislocated by war and living in refugee camps in Lebanon, Turkey and Jordan followed by Afghani clients with family in

Pakistan. This is a common trend amongst recently arrived refugee communities in the region and is a significant part of the pro-bono work undertaken by the Migration Agents.

Advice and assistance was also given to clients from the following countries: China, Philippines, Thailand, India, South Sudan, Ethiopia, Burundi, Samoa, FYROM, Rwanda, Tibet, Mongolia, Bangladesh and Cambodia.

There were many enquiries from people seeking advice and affected by changes to Australian Citizenship laws which included:

- Increasing the general residence requirement to four years of permanent residence
- Introducing an English language test
- The addition of new test questions about Australian values
- Strengthening the pledge of commitment

During this reporting the proposed changes to citizenship had not yet passed through Parliament. Once this happens then the requirements to apply for citizenship will be clearer. Many organisations have written submissions to the government expressing their views and concerns about the impact of the proposed changes, particularly for those vulnerable sections of our community with low levels of English literacy and the current lengthy delays in processing.

Financial Statements



Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Annual Report - 30 June 2017

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Contents
30 June 2017

Responsible entities' report	2
Auditor's independence declaration	6
Independent auditor's report to the members of Northern Settlement Services Limited	7
Statement of profit or loss and other comprehensive income	9
Statement of financial position	10
Statement of changes in equity	11
Statement of cash flows	12
Notes to the financial statements	13
Responsible entities' declaration	22

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Responsible entities' report
30 June 2017

The responsible entities present their report, together with the financial statements, on the company for the year ended 30 June 2017.

Responsible entities

The following persons were responsible entities ('Directors') of the company during the whole of the financial year and up to the date of this report, unless otherwise stated:

Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers
Zoran Vasiljevic
Sania Young
Fr Nicholas Zervas
Christine Jordan
Anna Marendy
James Garvey (resigned 9 November 2016)
Jon Chin
Denise Hodgson (resigned 9 November 2016)
Georgina Ramsay (resigned 9 November 2016)
Ewa Korczynski
Zachary Ekandi

Principal activities

During the financial year the principal continuing activities of the company consisted of:

- providing welfare and information services.

Short and long term objectives

Northern Settlement Services has developed a strategic plan with objectives, strategies and indicators to guide and monitor the work of the organisation. The short and long term objectives are achieved through leadership, support and advocacy for the Migrant Resources Network and reviewed at each Board meeting using financial and non-financial key performance indicators. In this way, the organisation can continue to develop programs and activities across immigration areas that are responsive to member needs.

Operating result

The surplus of the company for the financial year amounted to \$76,673 (2016: \$262,009).

Information on responsible entities

Name:	Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers
Experience and expertise:	Retired - Director Hunter Health - Migrant Health Unit - Regional Co-ordinator NSW Ethnic Affairs Commission - Nurse Counsellor - Working Women's Centre - Current Board Member of Tinonee Gardens Multicultural Village
Special responsibilities:	Director, Chairperson, Public Officer, Audit Committee
Name:	Zoran Vasiljevic
Experience and expertise:	Practicing Solicitor - Over 15 year solicitor in Australia - 14 years lawyer/solicitor in Yugoslavia - Bosnian Community Representative
Special responsibilities:	Director

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Responsible entities' report
30 June 2017

Name:	Sania Young
Experience and expertise:	Extensive aged care experience - enrolled nurse - Diploma in Community Development - Diploma in Social Science - Diploma of Librarian - Tartar Community Representative
Special responsibilities:	Director, Company Secretary
Name:	Fr Nicholas Zervas
Experience and expertise:	Priest of the Greek Community of Newcastle since 1973 - Life member of Ethnic Communities Council of Newcastle and Hunter - Greek Community Representative - Meals on Wheels - Volunteer 21 years - Fronditha Aged Care Nursing Home - Life member
Special responsibilities:	Director
Name:	Christine Jordan
Experience and expertise:	Retired - Bachelor of Social Services - Over 20 years in Child Protection - Juvenile Justice - Nursing - General/Psych, Aged and Disability - Resettlement Office for Newly Arrived Migrants (Red Cross) - Polish Community Representative
Special responsibilities:	Director, Treasurer, Audit Committee
Name:	Anna Marendy
Experience and expertise:	Retired - Founding member and life member of Fronditha Aged Care Nursing Home - Greek Community Representative - Over 25 years volunteer with Hippocrates Assoc.
Special responsibilities:	Director
Name:	James Garvey (resigned 9 November 2016)
Experience and expertise:	- Local Businessman - Bachelor of Science, Business and Administration - Real Estate Construction Management - University of Denver
Special responsibilities:	Director, Assistant Treasurer
Name:	Jon Chin
Experience and expertise:	Local Businessman - Extensive experience working with Board in the Club industry
Special responsibilities:	Director, Assistant Secretary
Name:	Denise Hodgson (resigned 9 November 2016)
Experience and expertise:	Retired - Assoc. Diploma of Social Welfare and Bachelor of Social Science - Over 20 years with the Public Service specialising in Multicultural Access
Special responsibilities:	Director
Name:	Georgina Ramsay (resigned 9 November 2016)
Experience and expertise:	Sessional Academic, Lecturer and Tutor at The University of Newcastle - PhD in Sociology and Anthropology - Experience in Volunteer Coordination - Welfare Programs, Homework Centre Coordinator
Special responsibilities:	Director

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Responsible entities' report
30 June 2017

Name:	Ewa Korczynski
Experience and expertise:	- Community Options Unit Service Director - Hunter New England Health for over 20 years - Bachelor of Applied Science - Hon.; Grad. Diploma of Welfare Law - Volunteer crew member o James Craig the tall ship (Sydney Maritime Museum) and volunteer with Dog Rescue Newcastle
Special responsibilities:	Director, Audit Committee
Name:	Zachary Ekandi
Experience and expertise:	Institute Multicultural Education Coordinator - Advisory Council Member - Regional Advisory Council Multicultural NSW - Advisory Committee Member - Multicultural Advisory Committee NSW Police Force - Advisory Committee Member - Multicultural Advisory Committee Wyong Shire Council - Accredited Interpreter NAATI - SEO - IMEC at Hunter TAFE NSW Online/Remote Information Technology Officer - IT Support Officer Students Union - University of Newcastle
Special responsibilities:	Director

Company secretary

The following person held the position of company secretary at the end of the financial year:

Sania Young is the representative of the Tartar Community and was appointed Company Secretary on 21 April 2010.

Meetings of responsible entities

The number of meetings of the company's Board of Directors ('the Board') held during the year ended 30 June 2017, and the number of meetings attended by each director were:

	Full Board Attended	Held
Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers	10	10
Zoran Vasiljevic	8	10
Sania Young	9	10
Fr Nicholas Zervas	5	10
Christine Jordan	8	10
Anna Marendy	6	10
James Garvey (resigned 9 November 2016)	1	4
Jon Chin	6	10
Denise Hodgson (resigned 9 November 2016)	2	4
Georgina Ramsay (resigned 9 November 2016)	-	4
Ewa Korczynski	8	10
Zachary Ekandi	8	10

Held: represents the number of meetings held during the time the director held office.

Indemnifying officer or auditor

During the year, the company effected a directors and officers liability policy. The insurance policy provides cover for the directors named in this report, the company secretary, officers and former directors and officers of the company. This policy prohibits the disclosure of the nature of the indemnification, the insurance cover and the amount of the premium.

No indemnities have been given or insurance premiums paid, during or since the end of the financial year, for any person who is or has been an auditor of the company.

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Responsible entities' report
30 June 2017

Contributions on winding up

In the event of the company being wound up, ordinary members are required to contribute a maximum of \$10 each.

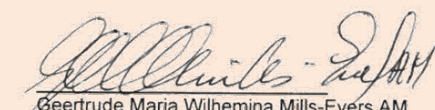
The total amount that members of the company are liable to contribute if the company is wound up is \$380, based on 38 current ordinary members (2016: 37).

Auditor's independence declaration

A copy of the auditor's independence declaration is set out immediately after this directors' report.

This report is made in accordance with a resolution of the directors.

On behalf of the responsible entities


Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers AM
Chairperson

18 October 2017

Unit 1, 1 Pioneer Avenue
PO Box 3399
Tuggerah NSW 2259

T: (02) 4353 2333
F: (02) 4351 2477

e: mail@bishopcollins.com.au



BISHOP COLLINS AUDIT PTY LTD

ABN: 98 159 109 305

Suite 1, Level 11
49-51 York Street
Sydney NSW 2000

T: (02) 9262 4420
F: (02) 9262 4739

w: www.bishopcollins.com.au

INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S DECLARATION TO THE MEMBERS OF NORTHERN SETTLEMENT SERVICES LIMITED

We hereby declare that to the best of our knowledge and belief during the year ended 30 June 2017, there have been:

- (i) no contraventions of the auditor independence requirements as set out in the *Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012* in relation to the audit; and
- (ii) no contraventions of any applicable code of professional conduct in relation to the audit.

Name of Firm

Bishop Collins Audit Pty Ltd
Chartered Accountants

Name of Registered Company Auditor


Martin Le Marchant

Auditor's Registration No.

431227

Address

Unit 1, 1 Pioneer Avenue, Tuggerah NSW 2259

Dated

18 October 2017



LIABILITY LIMITED BY A SCHEME APPROVED UNDER THE PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS LEGISLATION



Registered Company Auditors

David A. McClellan FCA

Glenn A. Harris CA

Martin Le Marchant CA

Unit 1, 1 Pioneer Avenue
PO Box 3399
Tuggerah NSW 2259

T: (02) 4353 2333
F: (02) 4351 2477

e: mail@bishopcollins.com.au



BISHOP COLLINS AUDIT PTY LTD

ABN: 98 159 109 305

Suite 1, Level 11
49-51 York Street
Sydney NSW 2000

T: (02) 9262 4420
F: (02) 9262 4739

w: www.bishopcollins.com.au

INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT TO THE MEMBERS OF NORTHERN SETTLEMENT SERVICES LIMITED

Audit Opinion

We have audited the accompanying financial report of Northern Settlement Services Limited ('the Company') which comprises the statement of financial position as at 30 June 2017, statement of profit or loss and other comprehensive income, statement of changes in equity and statement of cash flows for the year ended on that date, notes comprising a summary of significant accounting policies and other explanatory information and the Responsible Entities' Declaration.

In our opinion the accompanying financial report of Northern Settlement Services Limited is in accordance with the *Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012*, including:

- (i) giving a true and fair view of the Company's financial position as at 30 June 2017 and of its performance for the year ended on that date; and
- (ii) complying with Australian Accounting Standards – Reduced Disclosure Requirements (including the Australian Accounting Interpretations) and the *Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Regulation 2013*.

Basis for Opinion

We conducted our audit in accordance with Australian Auditing Standards. Our responsibilities under those standards are further described in the *Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Report* section of our report. We are independent of the Company in accordance with the ethical requirements of the Accounting Professional and Ethical Standards Board's APES 110 Code of Ethics for Professional Accountants (the Code) that are relevant to our audit of the financial report in Australia. We also fulfilled our other ethical responsibilities in accordance with the Code.

We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion.

Responsible Entities' Responsibilities for the Financial Report

The Responsible Entities ('Directors') of the Company are responsible for the preparation of the financial report that gives a true and fair view in accordance with Australian Accounting Standards – Reduced Disclosure Requirements and the *Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012*, and for such internal control as the Directors determine is necessary to enable the preparation of the financial report that gives a true and fair view and is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

In preparing the financial report, the Directors are responsible for assessing the Company's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern and using the going concern basis of accounting unless the Directors either intend to liquidate the Company or to cease operations, or have no realistic alternative but to do so.



CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS

LIABILITY LIMITED BY A SCHEME APPROVED UNDER THE PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS LEGISLATION



Registered Company Auditors: David A McDielland FCA

Gein A Harris CA

Marlin Le Marchant CA



Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Report

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial report as a whole is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an auditor's report that includes our opinion. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance, but is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with the Australian Auditing Standards will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of this financial report.

As part of an audit in accordance with the Australian Auditing Standards, we exercise professional judgement and maintain professional scepticism throughout the audit. We also:

- Identify and assess the risks of material misstatement of the financial report, whether due to fraud or error, design and perform audit procedures responsive to those risks, and obtain audit evidence that is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion. The risk of not detecting a material misstatement resulting from fraud is higher than for one resulting from error, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal control.
- Obtain an understanding of internal control relevant to the audit in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of the Company's internal control.
- Evaluate the appropriateness of accounting policies used and the reasonableness of accounting estimates and related disclosures made by the Directors.
- Conclude on the appropriateness of the Directors' use of the going concern basis of accounting in the preparation of the financial report. We also conclude, based on the audit evidence obtained, whether a material uncertainty exists related to events or conditions that may cast significant doubt on the Company's ability to continue as a going concern. If we conclude that a material uncertainty exists, we are required to draw attention in our auditor's report to the disclosures in the financial report about the material uncertainty or, if such disclosures are inadequate, to modify the opinion on the financial report. Our conclusions are based on the audit evidence obtained up to the date of our auditor's report. However, future events or conditions may cause the Company to cease to continue as a going concern.
- Evaluate the overall presentation, structure and content of the financial report, including the disclosures, and whether the financial report represents the underlying transactions and events in a manner that achieves fair presentation.

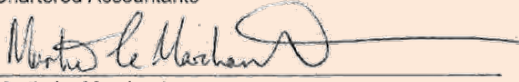
We communicate with the Directors regarding, among other matters, the planned scope and timing of the audit and significant audit findings, including any significant deficiencies in internal control that we identify during our audit.

We also provide the Directors with a statement that we have complied with relevant ethical requirements regarding independence, and to communicate with them all relationships and other matters that may reasonably be thought to bear on our independence, and where applicable, related safeguards.

Name of Firm

Bishop Collins Audit Pty Ltd
Chartered Accountants

Name of Registered Company Auditor


Martin Le Marchant

Auditor's Registration No.

431227

Address

Unit 1, 1 Pioneer Avenue, Tuggerah NSW 2259

Dated

18 October 2017

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Statement of profit or loss and other comprehensive income
For the year ended 30 June 2017

	Note	2017 \$	2016 \$
Revenue	4	3,108,509	3,110,917
Other income	5	29,647	84,710
Expenses			
Advertising expenses		(8,645)	(7,527)
Auditor's remuneration		(14,950)	(22,730)
Computer expenses		(15,082)	(18,592)
Depreciation and amortisation expense		(92,134)	(90,118)
Employee benefits expense		(2,144,469)	(2,026,863)
Facilities and cleaning expenses		(42,686)	(33,132)
Finance costs		-	(2,671)
Insurance expenses		(17,363)	(23,220)
Motor vehicle expenses		(5,191)	(9,371)
Printing, postage and stationery expenses		(23,069)	(33,584)
Program expenses		(159,834)	(155,371)
Office expenses		(12,819)	(13,214)
Service expenses		(389,106)	(335,095)
Subscriptions and membership expenses		(4,986)	(6,500)
Training and travelling expenses		(28,672)	(43,449)
Utilities expense		(33,278)	(33,958)
Volunteer expenses		(40,236)	(36,186)
Workers compensation expenses		(24,319)	(34,342)
Other expenses		(4,644)	(7,695)
Surplus before income tax expense		76,673	262,009
Income tax expense		-	-
Surplus after income tax expense for the year	16	76,673	262,009
Other comprehensive income for the year, net of tax		-	-
Total comprehensive income for the year		<u>76,673</u>	<u>262,009</u>

The above statement of profit or loss and other comprehensive income should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Statement of financial position
As at 30 June 2017

	Note	2017 \$	2016 \$
Assets			
Current assets			
Cash and cash equivalents	6	2,363,427	1,712,184
Trade and other receivables	7	58,165	127,444
Held-to-maturity investments	8	840,533	529,654
Other current assets	9	20,274	843
Total current assets		<u>3,282,399</u>	<u>2,370,125</u>
Non-current assets			
Property, plant and equipment	10	<u>1,054,108</u>	<u>1,123,898</u>
Total non-current assets		<u>1,054,108</u>	<u>1,123,898</u>
Total assets		<u>4,336,507</u>	<u>3,494,023</u>
Liabilities			
Current liabilities			
Trade and other payables	11	187,559	143,462
Employee benefits	12	327,006	279,453
Other current liabilities	13	<u>732,104</u>	<u>71,757</u>
Total current liabilities		<u>1,246,669</u>	<u>494,672</u>
Non-current liabilities			
Employee benefits	15	<u>50,156</u>	<u>36,342</u>
Total non-current liabilities		<u>50,156</u>	<u>36,342</u>
Total liabilities		<u>1,296,825</u>	<u>531,014</u>
Net assets		<u>3,039,682</u>	<u>2,963,009</u>
Equity			
Retained surpluses	16	<u>3,039,682</u>	<u>2,963,009</u>
Total equity		<u>3,039,682</u>	<u>2,963,009</u>

The above statement of financial position should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Statement of changes in equity
For the year ended 30 June 2017

	Retained surpluses \$	Total equity \$
Balance at 1 July 2015	2,701,000	2,701,000
Surplus after income tax expense for the year	262,009	262,009
Other comprehensive income for the year, net of tax	-	-
Total comprehensive income for the year	<u>262,009</u>	<u>262,009</u>
Balance at 30 June 2016	<u>2,963,009</u>	<u>2,963,009</u>
	Retained surpluses \$	Total equity \$
Balance at 1 July 2016	2,963,009	2,963,009
Surplus after income tax expense for the year	76,673	76,673
Other comprehensive income for the year, net of tax	-	-
Total comprehensive income for the year	<u>76,673</u>	<u>76,673</u>
Balance at 30 June 2017	<u>3,039,682</u>	<u>3,039,682</u>

The above statement of changes in equity should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Statement of cash flows
For the year ended 30 June 2017

	Note	2017 \$	2016 \$
Cash flows from operating activities			
Receipts from customers (inclusive of GST)		4,133,524	3,160,530
Payments to suppliers (inclusive of GST)		<u>(3,178,705)</u>	<u>(2,869,036)</u>
		954,819	291,494
Interest received		29,647	44,935
Interest and other finance costs paid		<u>-</u>	<u>(2,671)</u>
Net cash from operating activities		<u>984,466</u>	<u>333,758</u>
Cash flows from investing activities			
Payments for investments		(310,879)	-
Payments for property, plant and equipment		<u>(22,344)</u>	<u>(185,942)</u>
Proceeds from investments		-	220,829
Proceeds from disposal of property, plant and equipment		<u>-</u>	<u>50,454</u>
Net cash from/(used in) investing activities		<u>(333,223)</u>	<u>85,341</u>
Cash flows from financing activities			
Repayment of borrowings		<u>-</u>	<u>(273,600)</u>
Net cash used in financing activities		<u>-</u>	<u>(273,600)</u>
Net increase in cash and cash equivalents		651,243	145,499
Cash and cash equivalents at the beginning of the financial year		<u>1,712,184</u>	<u>1,566,685</u>
Cash and cash equivalents at the end of the financial year	6	<u><u>2,363,427</u></u>	<u><u>1,712,184</u></u>

The above statement of cash flows should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2017

Note 1. General information

The financial statements cover Northern Settlement Services Limited as an individual entity which is incorporated and domiciled in Australia. The financial statements are presented in Australian dollars, which is Northern Settlement Services Limited's functional and presentation currency.

Northern Settlement Services Limited is a not-for-profit unlisted public company limited by guarantee.

The financial statements were authorised for issue, in accordance with a resolution of responsible entities, on 18 October 2017.

Note 2. Significant accounting policies

The principal accounting policies adopted in the preparation of the financial statements are set out below. These policies have been consistently applied to all the years presented, unless otherwise stated.

New or amended Accounting Standards and Interpretations adopted

The company has adopted all of the new or amended Accounting Standards and Interpretations issued by the Australian Accounting Standards Board ('AASB') that are mandatory for the current reporting period.

Any new or amended Accounting Standards or Interpretations that are not yet mandatory have not been early adopted.

Basis of preparation

These general purpose financial statements have been prepared in accordance with Australian Accounting Standards - Reduced Disclosure Requirements and Interpretations issued by the Australian Accounting Standards Board ('AASB') and the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012.

Historical cost convention

The financial statements have been prepared under the historical cost convention, except for, where applicable, the revaluation of available-for-sale financial assets, financial assets and liabilities at fair value through profit or loss, investment properties, certain classes of property, plant and equipment and derivative financial instruments.

Critical accounting estimates

The preparation of the financial statements requires the use of certain critical accounting estimates. It also requires management to exercise its judgement in the process of applying the company's accounting policies. The areas involving a higher degree of judgement or complexity, or areas where assumptions and estimates are significant to the financial statements, are disclosed in note 3.

Revenue recognition

Revenue is recognised when it is probable that the economic benefit will flow to the company and the revenue can be reliably measured. Revenue is measured at the fair value of the consideration received or receivable.

Rendering of services

Stage of completion is measured by reference to hours incurred to date as a percentage of total estimated hours for each contract. Where the contract outcome cannot be reliably estimated, revenue is only recognised to the extent of the recoverable costs incurred to date.

Grants

A number of the Company's programs are supported by grants received from the federal, state and local governments. If conditions are attached to a grant which must be satisfied before the Company is eligible to receive the contribution, recognition of the grant as revenue is deferred until those conditions are satisfied. Where a grant is received on the condition that specified services are delivered, to the grantor, this is considered a reciprocal transaction. Revenue is recognised as services are performed and at year-end until the service is delivered. Revenue from a non-reciprocal grant that is not subject to conditions is recognised when the Company obtains control of the funds, economic benefits are probable and the amount can be measured reliably. Where a grant may be required to be repaid if certain conditions are not satisfied, a liability is recognised at year end to the extent that conditions remain unsatisfied. Where the company receives a non-reciprocal contribution of an asset from a government or other party for no or nominal consideration, the asset is recognised at fair value and a corresponding amount of revenue is recognised.

Note 2. Significant accounting policies (continued)

Interest

Interest revenue is recognised as interest accrues using the effective interest method. This is a method of calculating the amortised cost of a financial asset and allocating the interest income over the relevant period using the effective interest rate, which is the rate that exactly discounts estimated future cash receipts through the expected life of the financial asset to the net carrying amount of the financial asset.

Rent

Rent revenue is recognised on a straight-line basis over the lease term.

Other revenue

Other revenue is recognised when it is received or when the right to receive payment is established.

Income tax

As the company is a charitable institution in terms of subsection 50-5 of the Income Tax Assessment Act 1997, as amended, it is exempt from paying income tax.

Current and non-current classification

Assets and liabilities are presented in the statement of financial position based on current and non-current classification.

An asset is classified as current when: it is either expected to be realised or intended to be sold or consumed in the company's normal operating cycle; it is held primarily for the purpose of trading; it is expected to be realised within 12 months after the reporting period; or the asset is cash or cash equivalent unless restricted from being exchanged or used to settle a liability for at least 12 months after the reporting period. All other assets are classified as non-current.

A liability is classified as current when: it is either expected to be settled in the company's normal operating cycle; it is held primarily for the purpose of trading; it is due to be settled within 12 months after the reporting period; or there is no unconditional right to defer the settlement of the liability for at least 12 months after the reporting period. All other liabilities are classified as non-current.

Cash and cash equivalents

Cash and cash equivalents includes cash on hand, deposits held at call with financial institutions, other short-term, highly liquid investments with original maturities of three months or less that are readily convertible to known amounts of cash and which are subject to an insignificant risk of changes in value.

Trade and other receivables

Trade receivables are initially recognised at fair value and subsequently measured at amortised cost using the effective interest method, less any provision for impairment. Trade receivables are generally due for settlement within 30 days.

Collectability of trade receivables is reviewed on an ongoing basis. Debts which are known to be uncollectable are written off by reducing the carrying amount directly. A provision for impairment of trade receivables is raised when there is objective evidence that the company will not be able to collect all amounts due according to the original terms of the receivables. Significant financial difficulties of the debtor, probability that the debtor will enter bankruptcy or financial reorganisation and default or delinquency in payments (more than 60 days overdue) are considered indicators that the trade receivable may be impaired. The amount of the impairment allowance is the difference between the asset's carrying amount and the present value of estimated future cash flows, discounted at the original effective interest rate. Cash flows relating to short-term receivables are not discounted if the effect of discounting is immaterial.

Other receivables are recognised at amortised cost, less any provision for impairment.

Investments and other financial assets

Investments and other financial assets are initially measured at fair value. Transaction costs are included as part of the initial measurement, except for financial assets at fair value through profit or loss. They are subsequently measured at either amortised cost or fair value depending on their classification. Classification is determined based on the purpose of the acquisition and subsequent reclassification to other categories is restricted.

Financial assets are derecognised when the rights to receive cash flows from the financial assets have expired or have been transferred and the company has transferred substantially all the risks and rewards of ownership.

Note 2. Significant accounting policies (continued)

Held-to-maturity investments

Held-to-maturity investments includes non-derivative financial assets with fixed or determinable payments and fixed maturities where the company has the positive intention and ability to hold the financial asset to maturity. This category excludes financial assets that are held for an undefined period. Held-to-maturity investments are carried at amortised cost using the effective interest rate method adjusted for any principal repayments. Gains and losses are recognised in profit or loss when the asset is derecognised or impaired.

Impairment of financial assets

The company assesses at the end of each reporting period whether there is any objective evidence that a financial asset or group of financial assets is impaired. Objective evidence includes significant financial difficulty of the issuer or obligor; a breach of contract such as default or delinquency in payments; the lender granting to a borrower concessions due to economic or legal reasons that the lender would not otherwise do; it becomes probable that the borrower will enter bankruptcy or other financial reorganisation; the disappearance of an active market for the financial asset; or observable data indicating that there is a measurable decrease in estimated future cash flows.

Property, plant and equipment

Land and Buildings are measured at cost. Buildings are measured at cost less accumulated depreciation and impairment losses.

Plant and equipment is stated at historical cost less accumulated depreciation and impairment. Historical cost includes expenditure that is directly attributable to the acquisition of the items.

Depreciation is calculated on a straight-line basis to write off the net cost of each item of property, plant and equipment (excluding land) over their expected useful lives as follows:

Buildings	40 years
Leasehold improvements	3-10 years
Plant and equipment	4-10 years
Motor vehicles	2-5 years

The residual values, useful lives and depreciation methods are reviewed, and adjusted if appropriate, at each reporting date.

Leasehold improvements and plant and equipment under lease are depreciated over the unexpired period of the lease or the estimated useful life of the assets, whichever is shorter.

An item of property, plant and equipment is derecognised upon disposal or when there is no future economic benefit to the company. Gains and losses between the carrying amount and the disposal proceeds are taken to profit or loss. Any revaluation surplus reserve relating to the item disposed of is transferred directly to retained profits.

Trade and other payables

These amounts represent liabilities for goods and services provided to the company prior to the end of the financial year and which are unpaid. Due to their short-term nature they are measured at amortised cost and are not discounted. The amounts are unsecured and are usually paid within 30 days of recognition.

Employee benefits

Short-term employee benefits

Liabilities for wages and salaries, including non-monetary benefits, annual leave and long service leave expected to be settled wholly within 12 months of the reporting date are measured at the amounts expected to be paid when the liabilities are settled.

Other long-term employee benefits

The liability for annual leave and long service leave not expected to be settled within 12 months of the reporting date are measured at the present value of expected future payments to be made in respect of services provided by employees up to the reporting date using the projected unit credit method. Consideration is given to expected future wage and salary levels, experience of employee departures and periods of service. Expected future payments are discounted using market yields at the reporting date on national government bonds with terms to maturity and currency that match, as closely as possible, the estimated future cash outflows.

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2017

Note 2. Significant accounting policies (continued)

Defined contribution superannuation expense

Contributions to defined contribution superannuation plans are expensed in the period in which they are incurred.

Goods and Services Tax ('GST') and other similar taxes

Revenues, expenses and assets are recognised net of the amount of associated GST, unless the GST incurred is not recoverable from the tax authority. In this case it is recognised as part of the cost of the acquisition of the asset or as part of the expense.

Receivables and payables are stated inclusive of the amount of GST receivable or payable. The net amount of GST recoverable from, or payable to, the tax authority is included in other receivables or other payables in the statement of financial position.

Cash flows are presented on a gross basis. The GST components of cash flows arising from investing or financing activities which are recoverable from, or payable to the tax authority, are presented as operating cash flows.

Economic Dependence

Northern Settlement Services Limited is dependent upon government departments for grant funding. At the date of this report, the directors have no reason to believe that the departments will not continue to support the company.

Note 3. Critical accounting judgements, estimates and assumptions

The preparation of the financial statements requires management to make judgements, estimates and assumptions that affect the reported amounts in the financial statements. Management continually evaluates its judgements and estimates in relation to assets, liabilities, contingent liabilities, revenue and expenses. Management bases its judgements, estimates and assumptions on historical experience and on other various factors, including expectations of future events, management believes to be reasonable under the circumstances. The resulting accounting judgements and estimates will seldom equal the related actual results. The judgements, estimates and assumptions that have a significant risk of causing a material adjustment to the carrying amounts of assets and liabilities (refer to the respective notes) within the next financial year are discussed below.

Provision for impairment of receivables

The provision for impairment of receivables assessment requires a degree of estimation and judgement. The level of provision is assessed by taking into account the recent sales experience, the ageing of receivables, historical collection rates and specific knowledge of the individual debtor's financial position.

Estimation of useful lives of assets

The company determines the estimated useful lives and related depreciation and amortisation charges for its property, plant and equipment and finite life intangible assets. The useful lives could change significantly as a result of technical innovations or some other event. The depreciation and amortisation charge will increase where the useful lives are less than previously estimated lives, or technically obsolete or non-strategic assets that have been abandoned or sold will be written off or written down.

Employee benefits provision

As discussed in note 2, the liability for employee benefits expected to be settled more than 12 months from the reporting date are recognised and measured at the present value of the estimated future cash flows to be made in respect of all employees at the reporting date. In determining the present value of the liability, estimates of attrition rates, pay increases through promotion and inflation, and probability factors have been taken into account.

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2017

Note 4. Revenue

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
<i>Sales revenue</i>		
Grant funding received	2,494,098	2,405,292
Government subsidies received	448,730	555,257
Client contributions received	58,843	318
SSI hosting fees	59,192	90,726
Donations received	8,139	16,758
	<u>3,069,002</u>	<u>3,068,351</u>
<i>Other revenue</i>		
Immigration services	21,488	22,420
Other revenue	18,019	20,146
	<u>39,507</u>	<u>42,566</u>
Revenue	<u><u>3,108,509</u></u>	<u><u>3,110,917</u></u>

Note 5. Other income

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Net gain on disposal of property, plant and equipment	-	39,775
Interest received	29,647	44,935
Other income	<u>29,647</u>	<u>84,710</u>

Note 6. Current assets - cash and cash equivalents

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Cash on hand and at bank	<u>2,363,427</u>	<u>1,712,184</u>

Note 7. Current assets - trade and other receivables

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Trade receivables	57,935	121,263
Receivable from related party	-	5,000
	<u>57,935</u>	<u>126,263</u>
Other receivables	<u>230</u>	<u>1,181</u>
	<u><u>58,165</u></u>	<u><u>127,444</u></u>

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2017

Note 8. Current assets - held-to-maturity investments

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Term deposits	<u>840,533</u>	<u>529,654</u>

Note 9. Current assets - other current assets

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Prepayments	<u>20,274</u>	<u>843</u>

Note 10. Non-current assets - property, plant and equipment

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Land - at cost	<u>390,000</u>	<u>390,000</u>
Buildings - at cost	519,269	519,269
Less: Accumulated depreciation	<u>(143,204)</u>	<u>(122,433)</u>
	<u>376,065</u>	<u>396,836</u>
Leasehold improvements - at cost	294,318	321,030
Less: Accumulated depreciation	<u>(62,118)</u>	<u>(78,365)</u>
	<u>232,200</u>	<u>242,665</u>
Plant and equipment - at cost	198,359	261,013
Less: Accumulated depreciation	<u>(178,075)</u>	<u>(223,666)</u>
	<u>20,284</u>	<u>37,347</u>
Motor vehicles - at cost	85,960	85,960
Less: Accumulated depreciation	<u>(50,401)</u>	<u>(28,910)</u>
	<u>35,559</u>	<u>57,050</u>
	<u><u>1,054,108</u></u>	<u><u>1,123,898</u></u>

Reconciliations

Reconciliations of the written down values at the beginning and end of the current financial year are set out below:

	Land	Buildings	Leasehold	Plant and	Motor	Total
	\$	\$	Improvements	Equipment	Vehicles	\$
Balance at 1 July 2016	390,000	396,836	242,665	37,347	57,050	1,123,898
Additions	-	-	18,376	3,968	-	22,344
Depreciation expense	<u>-</u>	<u>(20,771)</u>	<u>(28,841)</u>	<u>(21,031)</u>	<u>(21,491)</u>	<u>(92,134)</u>
Balance at 30 June 2017	<u><u>390,000</u></u>	<u><u>376,065</u></u>	<u><u>232,200</u></u>	<u><u>20,284</u></u>	<u><u>35,559</u></u>	<u><u>1,054,108</u></u>

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2017

Note 11. Current liabilities - trade and other payables

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Trade payables	49,814	52,188
BAS payable	58,226	23,649
Accrued expenses	52,428	43,146
Other payables	27,091	24,479
	<u>187,559</u>	<u>143,462</u>

Note 12. Current liabilities - employee benefits

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Annual leave	155,028	118,915
Long service leave	165,036	160,538
Other leave	6,942	-
	<u>327,006</u>	<u>279,453</u>

Note 13. Current liabilities - other current liabilities

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Grant funding received in advance	538,725	70,000
Government subsidies received in advance	177,579	1,757
Deferred revenue	15,800	-
	<u>732,104</u>	<u>71,757</u>

Note 14. Non-current liabilities - borrowings

Financing arrangements

Unrestricted access was available at the reporting date to the following lines of credit:

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Total facilities		
Bank loans	<u>-</u>	<u>351,428</u>
Used at the reporting date		
Bank loans	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>
Unused at the reporting date		
Bank loans	<u>-</u>	<u>351,428</u>

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2017

Note 15. Non-current liabilities - employee benefits

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Long service leave	<u>50,156</u>	<u>36,342</u>

Note 16. Equity - retained surpluses

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Retained surpluses at the beginning of the financial year	2,963,009	2,701,000
Surplus after income tax expense for the year	<u>76,673</u>	<u>262,009</u>
Retained surpluses at the end of the financial year	<u><u>3,039,682</u></u>	<u><u>2,963,009</u></u>

Note 17. Key management personnel disclosures

Compensation

The aggregate compensation made to responsible entities and other members of key management personnel of the company is set out below:

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Aggregate compensation	<u>168,605</u>	<u>163,342</u>

Note 18. Related party transactions

Key management personnel

Disclosures relating to key management personnel are set out in note 17.

Transactions with related parties

A company controlled by the CEO's son, supplied computer equipment and IT services to Northern Settlement Services Limited on normal commercial terms and conditions no more favourable than those available to other persons unless stated.

During 2016 the company also entered into sale transactions with Northern Settlement Services Limited employees for the disposal of three motor vehicles. One of these sales forms the receivable from other related party as a non-commercial personal loan agreement was entered into for this sale.

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Provision of IT services (Tantos IT, related party of CEO Lulu Tantos)	21,372	32,178
Sale of motor vehicles to employees	-	36,000

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2017

Note 18. Related party transactions (continued)

Receivable from and payable to related parties

The following balances are outstanding at the reporting date in relation to transactions with related parties:

	2017	2016
	\$	\$
Current receivables:		
Receivable from other related party	-	5,000
Current payables:		
Trade payables to other related party	1,254	1,056

Note 19. Events after the reporting period

No matter or circumstance has arisen since 30 June 2017 that has significantly affected, or may significantly affect the company's operations, the results of those operations, or the company's state of affairs in future financial years.

Note 20. Segment reporting

Northern Settlement Services Limited operates in one economic sector being non-residential care services funded by government and individual users of their facilities.

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Responsible entities' declaration
30 June 2017

In the responsible entities' opinion:

- the attached financial statements and notes comply with the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012, the Australian Accounting Standards - Reduced Disclosure Requirements, the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Regulations 2013 and other mandatory professional reporting requirements;
- the attached financial statements and notes give a true and fair view of the company's financial position as at 30 June 2017 and of its performance for the financial year ended on that date; and
- there are reasonable grounds to believe that the company will be able to pay its debts as and when they become due and payable.

Signed in accordance with a resolution of directors.

On behalf of the responsible entities


Gertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers AM
Chairperson

18 October 2017



ABN 72 002 898 759
ACN 002 898 759

8 Chaucer Street
Hamilton NSW 2303
Ph: (02) 4969-3399
Fax: (02) 4961-4997
Email: nss@nsservices.com.au
Web: www.nsservices.com.au